HELP CENTER

User Guide

Academic Research Presentation Queueing and Rating System (ARPQRS) — registration, scheduling, live queueing and panel evaluation for academic research presentations.

For students, panelists, administrators and super administrators

Updated October 21, 2026

START WITH YOUR ROLE

Student / Research Group

Register your group and track your place in the queue.

Panelist

Evaluate groups and, as Lead, run the room.

Administrator

Set up categories, panels, the event day and reports.

Super Administrator

Manage accounts, settings, audit and backups.

Contents

1 Getting Started

What the system does · Who uses the system · What you need · Opening the system · Signing in · Your first sign-in · Finding your way around · Profile & account settings · Light and dark mode · Signing out

2 Students & Research Groups

No account needed · Browsing presentation categories · Registering your group · Registration rules · Your group reference · Choosing your panel · Viewing the schedule and queue · Planned, expected and actual times · On presentation day · Outcomes and what comes next

3 Panelists

Your panelist account · Dashboard · My Assignments · My Advisees · Marking yourself unavailable · Notifications · View Schedule · Lead Panelist, Member and Backup · Joining a room terminal · Evaluating a group · Running the room (Lead Panelist) · Scheduled breaks · Backups and substitutions

4 Room Session Devices

What a room device is · Checking a device · Setting up a device · The device screen · Releasing a device

5 Administrators

The presentation workflow · Dashboard · Panelist Management · Evaluation Library · Presentation Setup · Dates, rooms, tracks and breaks · Queue strategy and payment · How the queue is generated · Group & Panel Assignment · Assigning panels · Editing, moving and deferring groups · Re-defense · Event Control · How a day and a category end · Reports · Analytics · Needs Attention

6 Super Administrators

Dashboard · Admin Accounts · Panelist Oversight · Application Settings · Security Settings · Audit Log · Backups · Restoring a backup · Health and maintenance

7 Reference

Status reference · Presentation outcomes · How scores and grades are computed · Who can do what · Glossary

8 FAQ & Troubleshooting

Accounts and signing in · Registration and schedules · Panelists and room devices · Administration · Technical problems · Getting more help

CHAPTER 1

Getting Started

What the system is, who uses it, and the basics every user needs.

What the system does

The **Academic Research Presentation Queueing and Rating System (ARPQRS)** runs research presentations — capstone proposals, pre-oral and final defenses, title proposals — from registration to final grades. It replaces paper sign-up sheets, hand-written queue lists and paper evaluation forms with one shared, live system.

Online registration

Research groups register themselves for a presentation category, without an account.

Automatic scheduling

Groups are placed into rooms, days and time slots automatically once registration closes.

Live queue

Everyone sees who is presenting, who is next and the expected time of every group.

Digital evaluation

Panelists rate each group on a room device; scores and outcomes are computed instantly.

Reports and analytics

Grades, sign-off sheets, recommendations and schedule analytics, exportable to Excel and PDF.

Accountability

Every important action is recorded, and data is protected by backups.

Who uses the system

There are four kinds of users, plus the shared devices used inside each presentation room. Each chapter of this guide is written for one of them.

USER	ACCOUNT	WHAT THEY DO	CHAPTER
Student / Research Group	None	Register the group, view the schedule and queue, follow announcements.	2
Panelist	Created by an Administrator	View assignments and advisees, connect to a room terminal, evaluate groups; the Lead Panelist also runs the room.	3
Room Session device	Room account, new each day	A tablet or laptop in the room that panelists sign in to.	4
Administrator	Created by the Super Administrator	Runs everything for one college: panelists, forms, categories, schedules, panels, event day, reports.	5
Super Administrator	System owner	Creates Administrator accounts, manages colleges and school years, audit log, backups.	6

Each Administrator belongs to one **college**. They only see and manage that college's categories, panelists and evaluation forms. Students can browse every college's open categories.

What you need

- **A modern web browser** — Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox or Safari, kept up to date. Nothing needs to be installed.
- **An internet connection** to the address where your school hosts the system.
- **Panelists:** a phone with a camera is useful for joining a room by QR code, but not required — you can type your username and password on the room device instead.
- **Rooms:** one tablet or laptop per panel seat. See Checking a device to confirm an older tablet is compatible.

The system works on phones, tablets and computers. On a small screen the side menu is hidden; open it with the button at the top left.

Opening the system

Open the system's web address. The **home page** is the starting point for everyone:

Browse Presentations

The home page lists the presentations students can act on now — presenting now, registration open, opening soon — each with **Register** and **View Schedule** (**View Live Queue** while a day is running). **View all presentations** opens the full list.

Log in

Top-right button, for panelists, administrators and super administrators.

Room Session

Top-right button, used only on the devices inside a presentation room.

Help Center

This guide. It is linked from the top bar of every page and needs no sign-in.

Signing in

Panelists, Administrators and Super Administrators sign in with a **username** and **password**. Accounts are never self-registered: an Administrator creates panelist accounts, and the Super Administrator creates Administrator accounts.

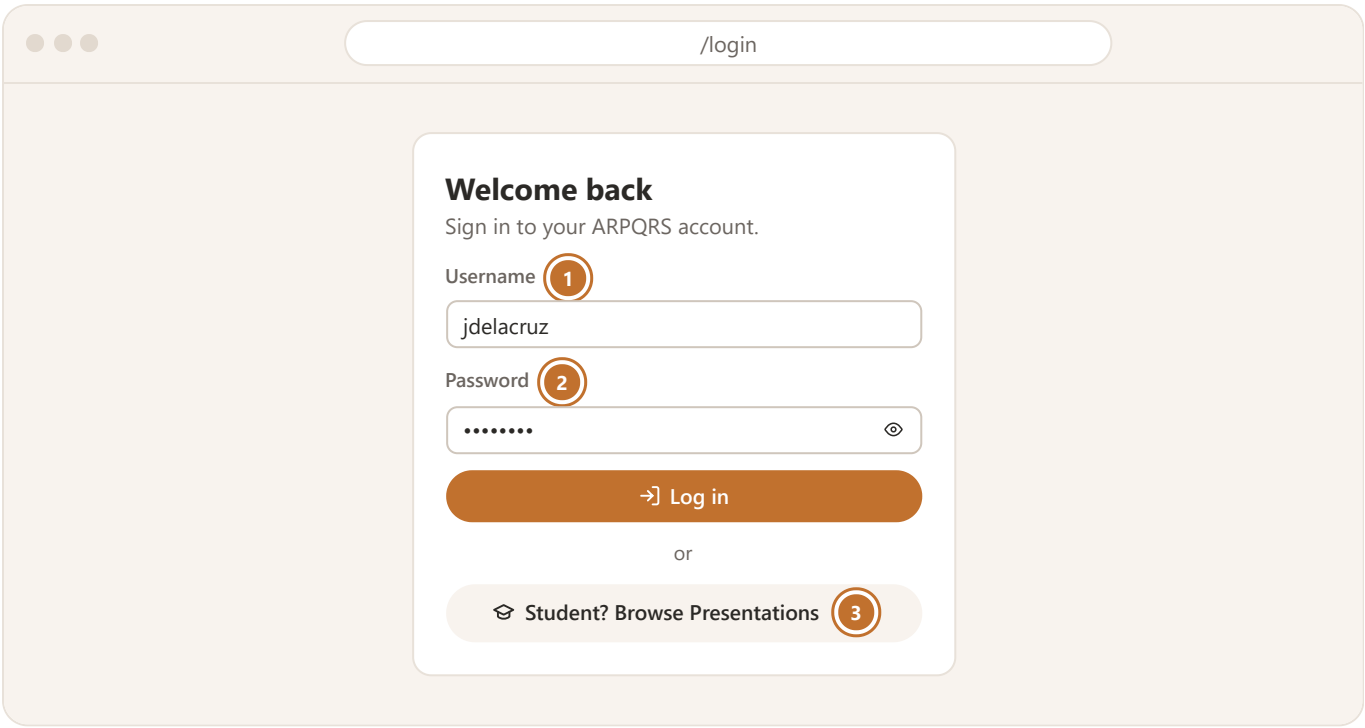


Figure 1. The sign-in page.

1. **Enter your username**

   Type it exactly as it was given to you.

2. **Enter your password and press Log in**

   The eye icon in the field shows what you typed. You land on your own dashboard. If you were sent to the sign-in page from a link (for example a QR code), you are taken back to that link instead.

3. **Students do not sign in**

   Student? Browse Presentations takes a student who landed here to the presentation list.

> ⚠ **Forgot your password?** There is no self-service reset. Ask your Administrator (panelists) or the Super Administrator (administrators) to reset it — you will receive a new temporary password.

Your first sign-in

New accounts and reset accounts start with a **temporary password**. The first time you sign in with it you are taken straight to **Change Password** — every role, panelists included. No other page opens until it is done:

1. **Type the temporary password as Current Password**

2. **Choose a new password and type it twice**

   At least 8 characters, with an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter and a number — the checklist under the field ticks each rule as you type. Use the eye icon to check what you typed. Never reuse the temporary one.

3 Update Password

You continue to your dashboard — or to the page you were opening, such as a notification link or a scanned terminal QR code. Until you do this, the rest of the system stays locked; you can choose **Log out instead** to come back later.

Account → Active

Temporary passwords are shown **once**, to the person who created or reset the account, and are never stored in a readable form. If it is lost before first use, it has to be reset again.

Finding your way around

Signed-in pages share the same layout:

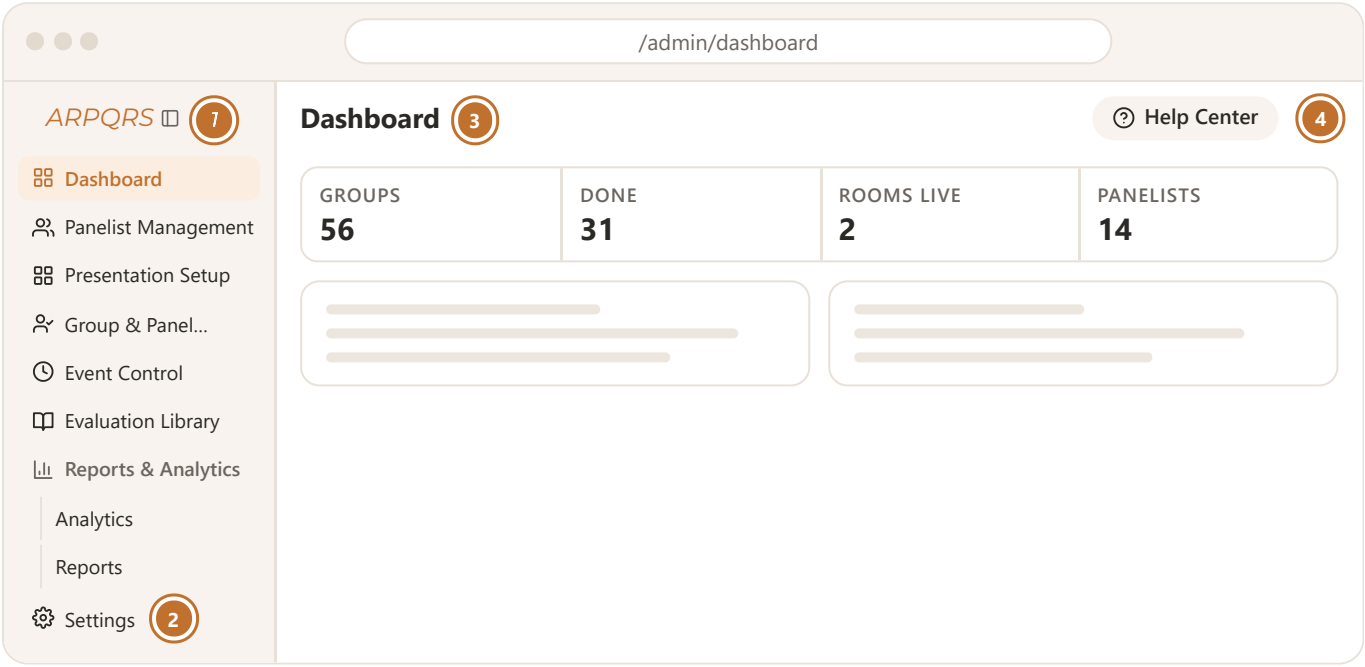


Figure 2. The signed-in layout (Administrator shown; other roles have their own menu items).

1. **Side menu** — every module of your role. The current page is highlighted. The ◫ button beside the name closes it to give the page more room; the same button at the top left of the page opens it again. Your browser remembers the choice.
2. **Settings** — your profile, password, appearance and Log out.
3. **Page title** — and, on some pages, a category picker or page actions.
4. **Help Center** — opens this guide at your role's chapter, in a new tab.

Common controls

⋮

A row's **three-dot menu** holds its actions (View, Edit, Delete…).

A **red dot** next to a tab or field marks something still incomplete.

Status

Coloured **badges** show status. See the Status reference.

Start

A **faded button** is not available yet. Hover over it (or press and hold on a tablet) to see why.

Saved

A short **toast message** in the corner confirms each save or explains an error.

Most pages refresh their live data on their own every few seconds. You do not need to reload to see a queue move.

Profile & account settings

Open **Settings** at the bottom of the side menu (or the ⚙ gear in the top bar on pages without a menu).

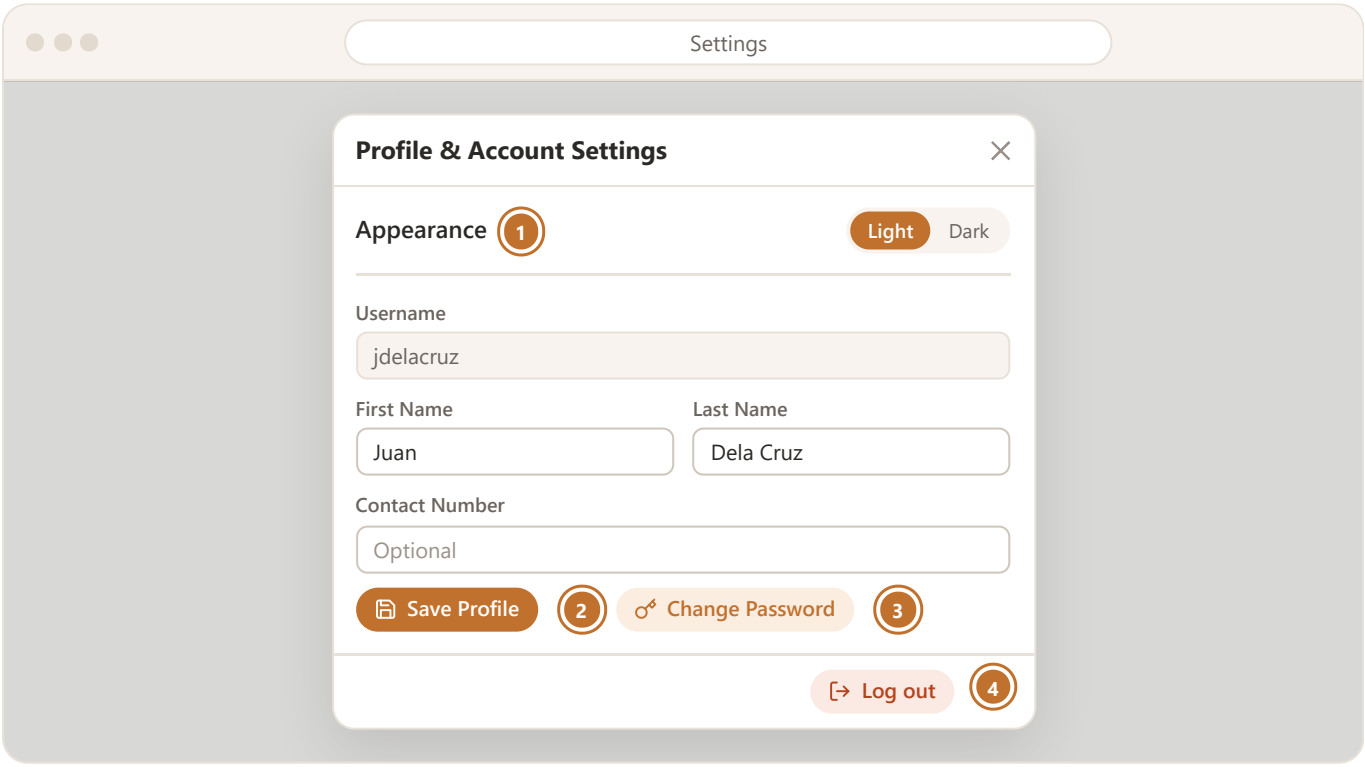


Figure 3. The Settings window.

1. **Appearance** — light or dark mode for this browser.
2. **Profile** — correct your name, suffix and contact number. Your username cannot be changed.
3. **Change Password** — any time; you will need your current password.
4. **Log out** — ends your session on this device.

Super Administrators also see an **Application Settings** link here.

Light and dark mode

Switch between light and dark mode in **Settings** → **Appearance**, or with the sun/moon button on pages without a menu (home page, sign-in, registration). The choice is remembered by your browser, so set it once per device. This guide always prints in light mode.

Signing out

Open **Settings** and choose **Log out**. Always sign out on a shared or public computer. Closing the browser tab alone does not sign you out.

> ⚠ Signing out of your **personal account** does not sign you out of a **room device**. On a room device, use the device's own Log Out button — see Joining a room terminal.

CHAPTER 2

Students & Research Groups

Register your group, follow the queue and get ready for presentation day. No account needed.

No account needed

Students and research groups do **not** have accounts and never sign in. Everything you need is public:

1. **Find your category**
   The home page lists the presentations you can act on now; press **Browse Presentations** to jump to them, or **View all presentations** for every category that is currently listed.
2. **Register once, as a group**
   The group leader fills in one registration for the whole group while registration is open.
3. **Keep your group reference**
   A reference such as `CFD-2026-0012` identifies your group from now on.
4. **Watch the schedule**
   After registration closes the system assigns your room, day and time. Check the schedule for your place in the queue and live updates.

Browsing presentation categories

A **presentation category** is one presentation event — for example "Capstone Final Defense". Each one is shown as a card:

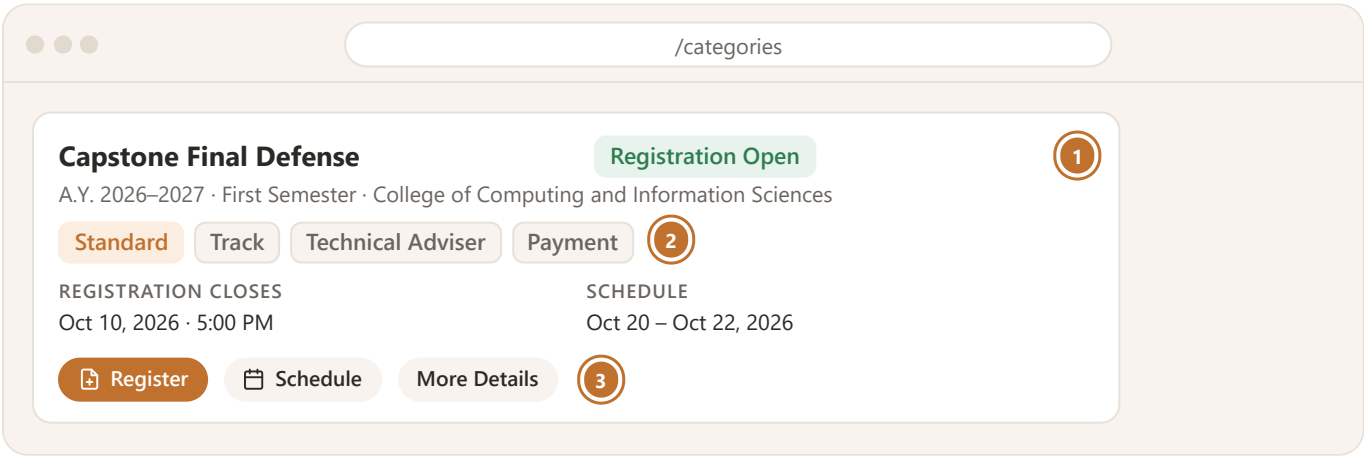


Figure 4. A presentation category card.

1. **Registration status** — Opens Soon, Registration Open or Registration Closed.
2. **Mode and requirements** — what the form will ask for (track, technical adviser, payment).
3. **Actions** — Register (only while open), view the Schedule (always), or More Details for the full description, dates and payment instructions. Announcements are on the Schedule page.

Presentation modes

Standard
Your group presents one project, under one **Project Title**. Panelists rate the project and each member.

OR

Title Proposal
Your group submits a set number of **Proposed Titles**; the panel evaluates each and approves one.

Registering your group

Only the **group leader** registers, once, for the whole group. Press **Register** on the category card while registration is open.

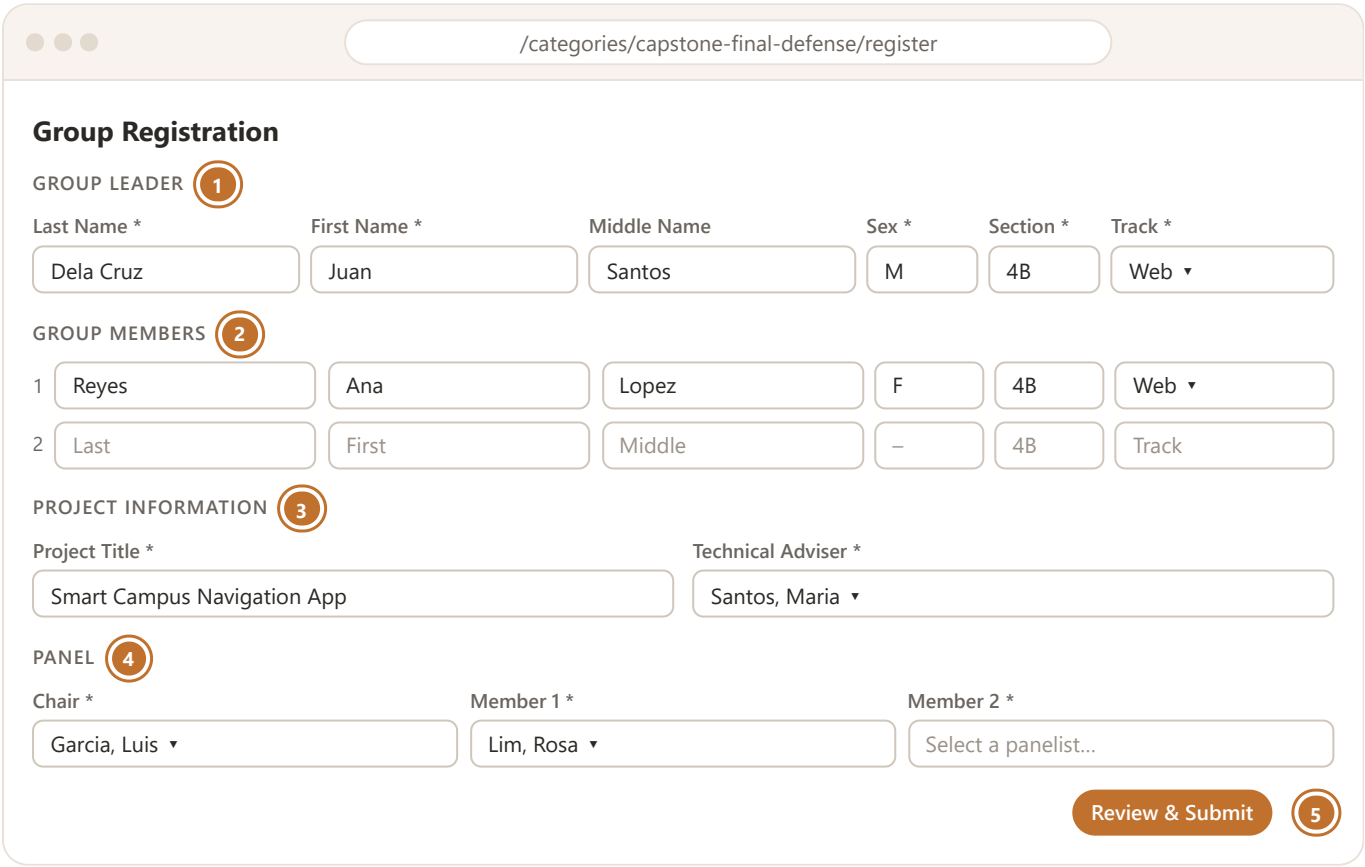


Figure 5. The registration form for a Standard category that requires a track and a technical adviser, and lets groups choose their panel.

1 **Group Leader**
Last, first and middle name, sex, section and — when the category asks for it — your research track. All required except the middle name.

2 **Group Members**
One row per member. The number of rows is the category's maximum group size minus the leader. Leave unused rows completely blank; a row you start must be filled in completely.

3 Project Information

Standard: your **Project Title**. Title Proposal: exactly the required number of **Proposed Titles**. Plus your **Technical Adviser** if the category requires one — choose them from the list of your college's panelists.

4 Panel (only in some categories)

If the category lets groups choose their panel, pick one panelist for each seat: the **Chair** first, then each **Member**. Each person can be picked once, and your adviser is greyed out. See Choosing your panel.

5 Review & Submit

The form checks everything, then shows a summary. Read it carefully. Choose **Back to Edit** to fix something, or **Confirm & Submit** to register.

Registration → Registration Recorded

> ⚠ **You cannot edit a registration after submitting.** If something is wrong — a misspelled name, a missing member, a wrong title — ask your Administrator to correct it. Do not register a second time.

Registration rules

FIELD	RULE
Names	Letters only; spaces, hyphens, apostrophes and periods are allowed. Names are tidied automatically (extra spaces removed, each word capitalised).
Section	A year level and a letter — `4B`, `3A`. No program prefix. Letters are capitalised for you, so `4b` and `4 - b` both become `4B`.
Sex	Male or Female.
Track	Shown only when the category requires it. If the category has a track list, choose from it; your group is scheduled into a room for its track.
Technical Adviser	Shown only when the category requires it. Choose from the list of your college's panelists; a name that is not on the list cannot be typed in.
Panel	Shown only when the category lets groups choose their panel. One panelist per seat (Chair, then Members), all different, and never your own adviser.
Members	A row is either completely blank (skipped) or completely filled. The same person cannot appear twice in a group.
Proposed Titles	Title Proposal categories only — exactly the number shown on the form.
Duplicates	A category refuses a second active registration with the same leader name, or (Standard mode) the same project title.
Window	Registration is accepted only between the category's opening and closing date and time.

Your group reference

After submitting you see **Registration Recorded** with your group's details and its **group reference**:



Figure 6. The confirmation page.

> Take a screenshot of this page or write the reference down. It is the quickest way for an Administrator to find your group. You can always find your group again by searching your group reference, leader's name or project title on the schedule page.

Viewing the schedule and queue

Press **Schedule** on the category card (or **View Schedule** after registering). Before the queue is generated, rooms show "Queue not generated yet for this room."

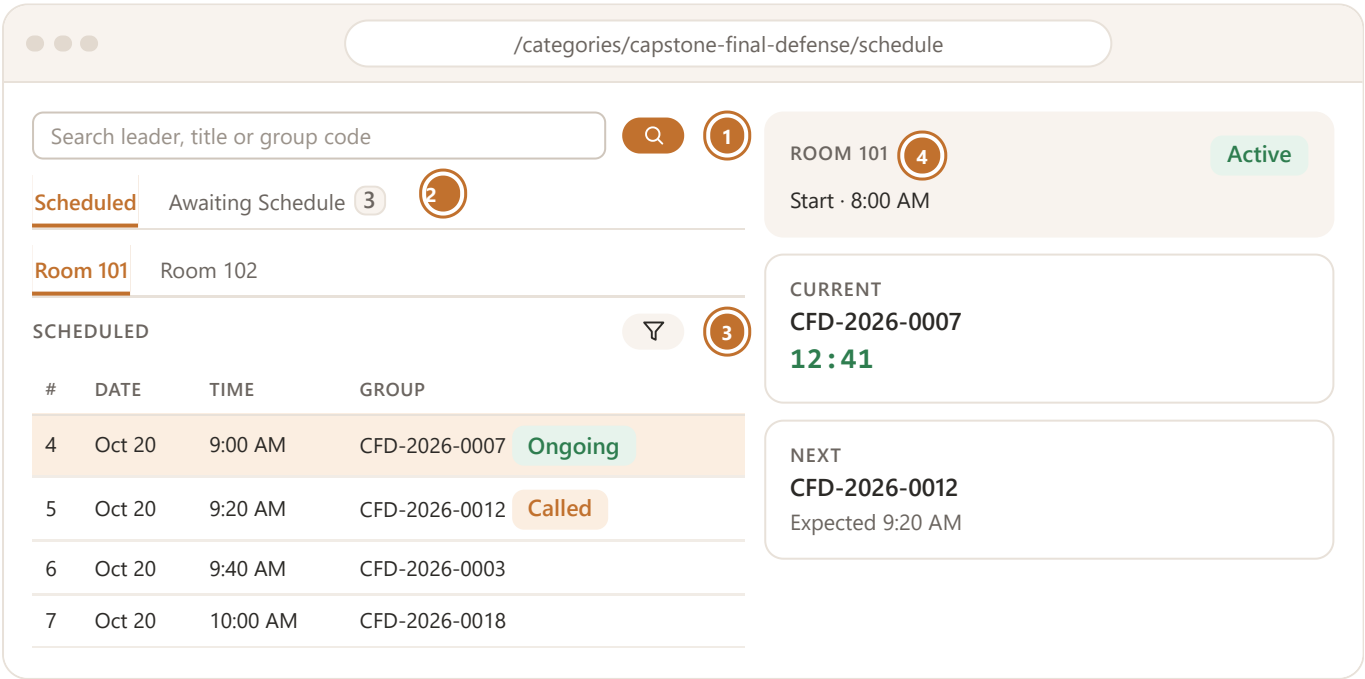


Figure 7. The schedule and queue page.

1. **Search** — type the leader's name, project title, a proposed title or the group code (e.g. `CFD-2026-0012`). Your group's status card appears with its room, time and panel.
2. **Scheduled / Awaiting Schedule** — **Scheduled** has one tab per room still in use, each listing every day that room runs. **Awaiting Schedule** lists groups waiting for a date, room or time slot, including groups registered before any date or room was set. These two tabs only appear when some groups are waiting.
3. **Filter** — switch a room's list between Scheduled (still to present), Completed and Deferred groups.
4. **Room status** — whether the room is running, its start time, the group presenting now with a live timer, and who is next.

Announcements from the Administrators appear at the bottom; use **View Announcements** at the top of the page to jump to them. The page updates itself — no need to reload.

Choosing your panel

Some categories let each group choose its own panelists. When the category allows it, the registration form has a **Panel** section; otherwise the Administrator assigns your panel.

- Pick one panelist for every seat. The first is the **Chair**, who runs the room and gives the official outcome; the rest are **Members**.
- Each panelist can be picked once. Your own technical adviser cannot sit on your panel and is greyed out.
- Your choices become your panel as soon as your group is placed in the queue. If a chosen panelist is already busy at your time, that seat is left for the Administrator to fill.
- The Administrator always chooses the backup (Alternate Panel), and can still change your panel later.

Registered before groups could choose?

If your group registered before the category allowed it and has no panel yet, search your group on the schedule page. The status card shows a **Select Panel** button under Assigned Panelists. Pick the Chair and Members and press **Save Panel**.

> ⚠ You can choose **once**. After saving, the button is gone; ask your Administrator if the panel has to change.

Planned, expected and actual times

The time shown next to a group depends on where the day is:

Planned

The day has not started. You see the slot the schedule planned.

Expected

The day is running. Times are re-estimated live from where the room actually is — if presentations run long, later times move later; if they run short, they move earlier.

Actual

Your group already presented (or was deferred). You see when it really happened.

To be scheduled

Your group still has to present but its day can no longer run (for example, every date has ended). Wait for the Administrator to add a new date — your place is kept.

⚠ Expected times are estimates. **Be at the room well before your expected time** — a group ahead of you may finish early or be deferred.

On presentation day

1. **Check your room and expected time**
   Search your group on the schedule page that morning — rooms or times may have changed.
2. **Wait to be called**
   The Lead Panelist calls the next group; your status changes to Called. Go in right away.
3. **Payment, if required**
   If the category requires payment, have each receipt's **reference number** ready. The Lead Panelist enters it before you can start. Each reference number can only ever be used once in the system.
4. **Present**
   The timer starts when the Lead presses Start. It turns red and counts extra time if you go over.
5. **Completed**
   After every panelist submits an evaluation, the Lead completes the presentation and your group moves to the Completed list.

If your group is deferred

A group can be Deferred — set aside for now. The reasons are: Not Present When Called, Incomplete Group (Member Absent), Not Ready to Present, System / Prototype Not Working, Incomplete Requirements, and Payment Not Verified. A deferred group is **not** removed: it appears in the Deferred list with the reason, and is put back into the queue later (by the Administrator, or automatically at the end of the queue at the end of the day). Talk to the panel or the Administrator if you are unsure.

Outcomes and what comes next

Each presentation ends with one official outcome, set from your Group Grade, rounded off to a whole percent (91–100% No Revision, 81–90% Minor, 71–80% Major, 61–70% Re-Defense, below 61% Failed):

OUTCOME	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOUR GROUP
Passed with No Revision	Done. Your grade is final.
Passed with Minor Revision	Done. Make the minor revisions the panel asked for.
Passed with Major Revision	Done. Make the major revisions the panel asked for.
Re-Defense	You present again. The Administrator re-inserts your group; a re-defense always goes **after every other group**, on the last open date, with a new panel.
Failed	Final for this registration. To present again you must **register again** as a new group (the old registration does not block you).

Grades are released by your Administrator. The system does not publish individual grades on the public pages.

CHAPTER 3

Panelists

See your assignments, join a room terminal, evaluate groups and run the room as Lead.

Your panelist account

Your Administrator registers you in **Panelist Management** and gives you a username and a temporary password. By default:

Username

Your first name in lower case, e.g. `maria`. A number is added if the name is taken: `maria2`.

Temporary password

Your first and last initials plus the school year's start year, e.g. `MS2026`.

Sign in and change the temporary password on first use — see Your first sign-in. Your account belongs to the Administrator's college; you can be assigned to any of that college's categories.

Dashboard

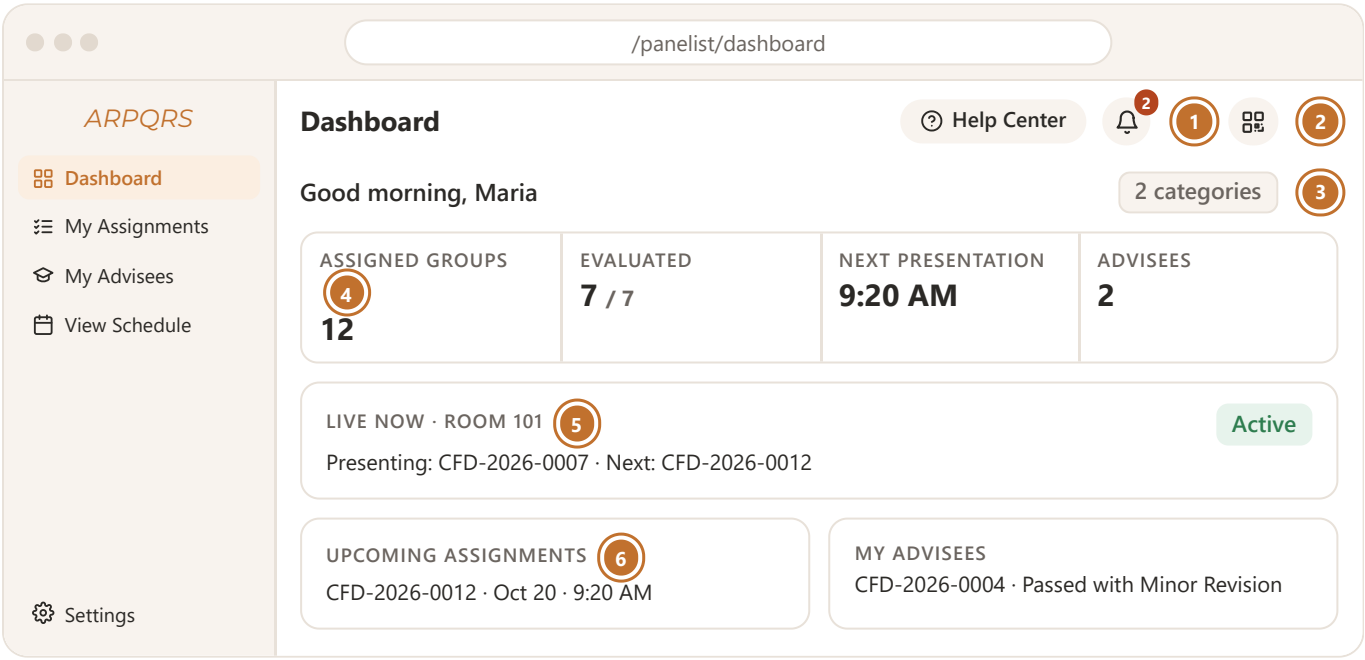


Figure 8. The Panelist dashboard.

1. **Notifications** — the number shows unread items.
2. **Room Session** — opens your phone camera to scan a room device's QR code.
3. **Categories** — the dashboard covers every category you serve on or advise in at once; point at the chip to see their names. Each row says which category it belongs to.
4. **Summary** — **Assigned Groups** (and how many are still to present), **Evaluated** (sheets you submitted out of groups that have presented), your **Next Presentation** with its room and group, and your **Advisees**.
5. **Live Now** — appears only while one of your rooms is running: who is presenting or called, and who is next.
6. **Upcoming Assignments** and **My Advisees** — the next few of each, nearest first; **View all** opens the full page.

My Assignments

Every group you are seated on, in three tabs:

Scheduled

Still to present, **nearest first**. Times are live expected times while a day is running.

Deferred

Set aside, with the real time and reason. View only.

Completed

Already presented, newest first, with the real completion time.

Each row's ⋮ menu offers **View** (the group's members, titles, room, time and your role). On a Completed row, **View Evaluation** opens the evaluation sheets the panel submitted. On a Scheduled row you can also **Mark Unavailable**. Search by group code, title or room, and filter by track or section.

Your role on each group is shown as Lead Panelist, Member or Backup Panelist — see Lead Panelist, Member and Backup.

My Advisees

The groups that name you as their **Technical Adviser**, in your college's categories. You do not evaluate these groups — this page lets you follow them.

Upcoming

Still to present, nearest first, with the room, time and panel. **View** shows the group's details and its panel.

Completed

Already presented, with the real completion time and the outcome. **View Evaluation** opens the sheets the panel submitted.

Search by group code, title or leader, and filter by track, section or category.

Recommendations Summary (upper right) lists the panel's comments for each of your advisees that has presented. **View** opens the list and **Export to PDF** downloads it. In the list, each group has **Print** and **Export to PDF** for its own Recommendation Form.

Marking yourself unavailable

If you cannot sit on a scheduled group, open its ⋮ menu in My Assignments and choose **Mark Unavailable**. This sends a report to your Administrator, who chooses your replacement.

1 **Report**

Row → Pending Review

2 **The Administrator assigns a replacement**

You get a notification "Marked unavailable for … Approved by …" and the group leaves your Scheduled list.

> ⚠ Until a replacement is assigned you are still on the panel. Report as early as possible, and tell your Administrator directly if the presentation is today.

Notifications

The 🔔 bell in the top bar lists what changed for you, newest first, each with its date and time. Clicking one marks it read and, where it applies, takes you to My Assignments with the affected rows highlighted.

New assignment
You were added to a panel — "Assigned to 3 groups." — by an Administrator, or chosen by a group at registration. Press **View** to see them.

Schedule changed
A group you sit on moved to another room, date or time.

Replaced on panel
Someone took your seat on a group (for example a backup at the room device).

Unavailability approved
Your Mark Unavailable report was handled and a replacement assigned.

View Schedule

The same live schedule and queue the students see (Viewing the schedule and queue), for any of your categories: room tabs, search (including by group code), Scheduled / Completed / Deferred lists, groups awaiting a schedule, the group presenting now and who is next. Searching a group also shows its assigned panelists.

Lead Panelist, Member and Backup

Lead Panelist (Chair)
Evaluates, and runs the room: Call Next, payment verification, Start, Pause, Complete, Defer and breaks. One per group.

Member
Evaluates every group on the panel from their own device.

Backup Panelist
On standby. Can take an assigned panelist's seat at the room device when they cannot attend.

Lead powers follow the **person**, not the device: whichever terminal the Lead signs in to gets the controls.

Joining a room terminal

Each room has one device per panel seat, already set up by the Administrator (Setting up a device). An empty device shows a QR code and a sign-in form. Join it one of two ways:

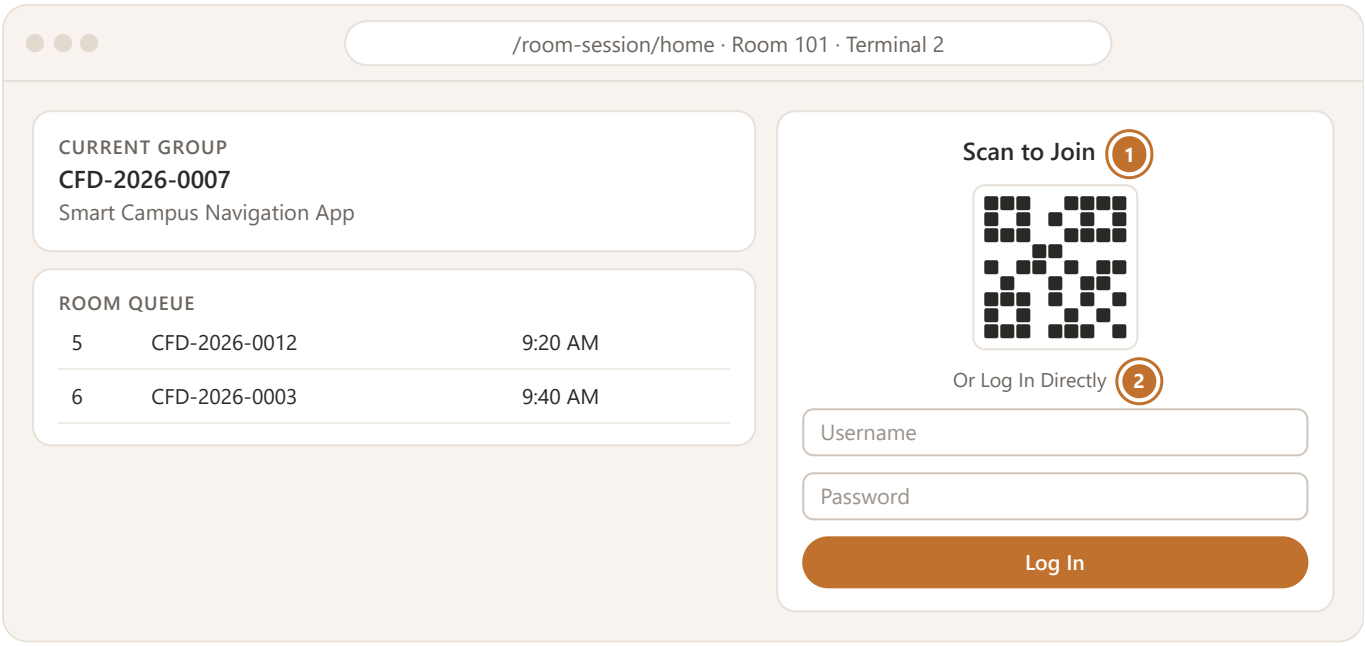


Figure 9. An empty room terminal waiting for its panelist.

1 Scan QR Code

On your phone, sign in to your own panelist account, tap the Room Session button in the top bar, point the camera at the device's code, then press **Join This Terminal?** → confirm. You can also scan with the phone's normal camera app. The code refreshes every few minutes.

OR

2 Log In Directly

Type **your own** username and password into the device's form. Never use the room account here.

Once connected the device shows your name and badges:

Can Evaluate

You are seated on the current group and can rate it.

Flow Control (Chair)

You are the Lead Panelist — the Presentation Controls appear.

Alternate Panel

You are a backup on this room.

Not Assigned

You are not on this panel; see Backups and substitutions.

When you leave the room, press **Log Out** on the device so the next panelist can sit. You cannot be connected to two seats in the same room.

Evaluating a group

When a group is called, the evaluation sheet opens on every connected panelist's device. It is the same sheet the Administrator built in the Evaluation Library. In a category with tracks, each track can have its own sheet; you get the one for the group's track.

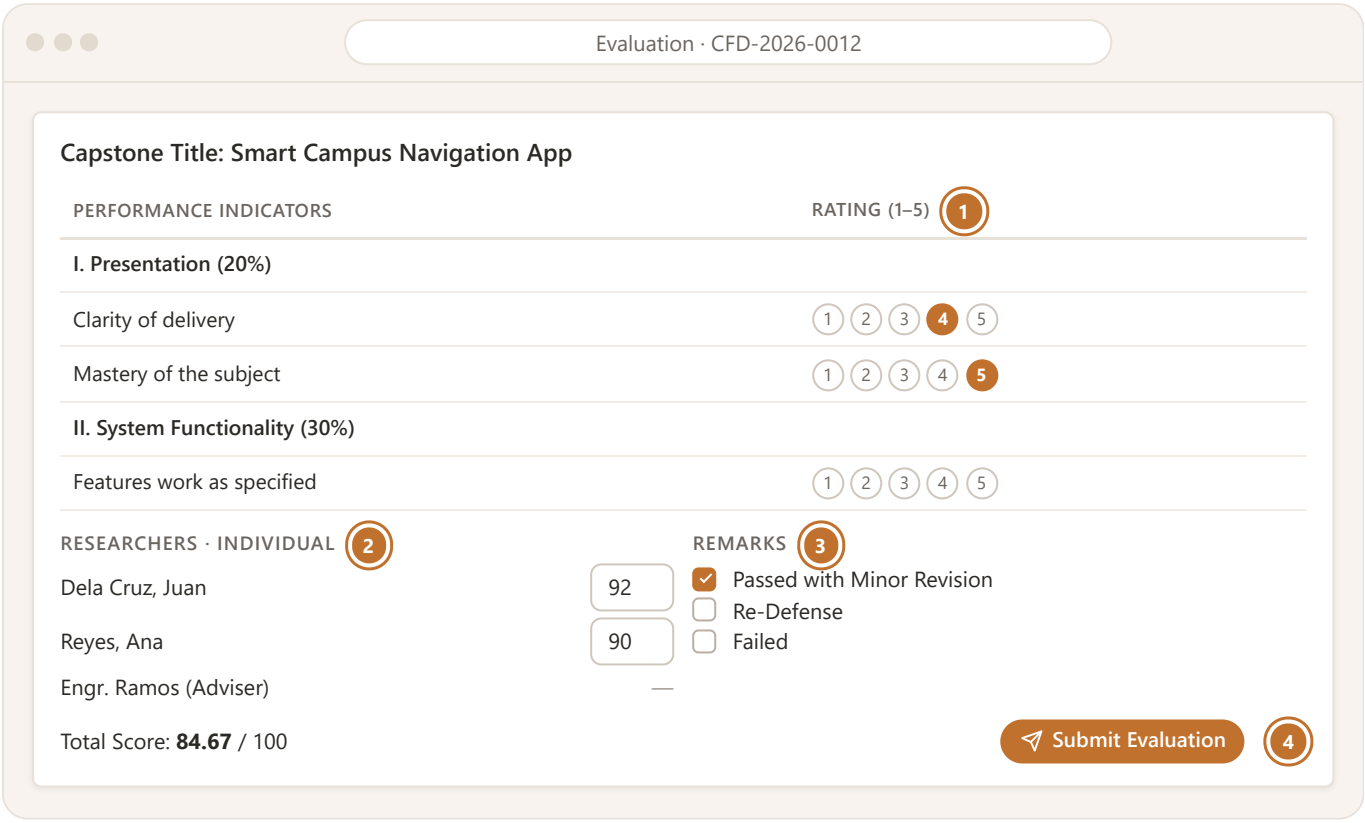


Figure 10. The evaluation sheet on a room device (Standard mode).

1. **Rate every criterion** from 1 (Very Insufficient) to 5 (Very Sufficient). Each tap is saved immediately.
2. **Individual score** for each researcher, 0–100 (Standard mode). The group's technical adviser is listed under the researchers but is not scored.
3. **Remarks** — marked automatically from the score when you submit (Title Proposal: choose one). Add comments if needed.
4. **Submit Evaluation** — available once every required part is filled.

Submitting is final. A submitted evaluation cannot be edited. Review your ratings before you submit.

Title Proposal mode

The criteria repeat once for each proposed title. Rate each title, and tick **Approved** on the title the panel accepts. There are no individual scores or total in this mode.

Running the room (Lead Panelist)

When you are signed in as the Lead, **Presentation Controls** appear on your device:

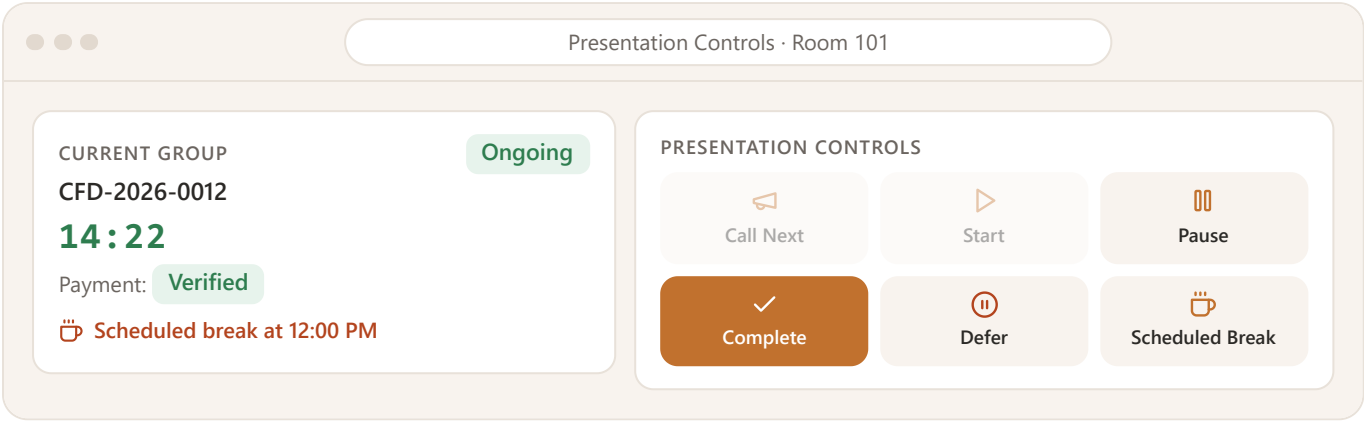


Figure 11. The Lead Panelist's controls while a group presents.

1. **Call Next**

   Calls the next group in the queue. Locked until **every terminal in the room has a panelist connected**, and while the room is on a break.

   Group → Called

2. **Verify payment (if required)**

   Type the reference number of every receipt (one field per payment type, all required), then press **Verify Payment** once. A number already used anywhere in the system is refused and the screen says which group holds it.

3. **Start**

   Starts the presentation timer. Locked until every payment type is verified, every seat has a panelist signed in, and everyone signed in is on this group's panel (assigned, or swapped in as a replacement). Point at the button to see what is missing.

   Group → Ongoing

4. **Pause / Resume**

   Stops the clock for an interruption; paused time does not count against the group. Going over the time limit is allowed — the timer turns red and shows the extra time.

5. **Complete**

   Ends the presentation. Locked until **every panelist has submitted** an evaluation. The official outcome is set from the Group Grade.

   Group → Completed

Deferring a group

Use **Defer This Group** when the called or presenting group cannot go on. Pick a reason (Not Present When Called, Incomplete Group, Not Ready to Present, System / Prototype Not Working, Incomplete Requirements, Payment Not Verified) and press **Confirm Defer**. The group leaves the active queue, the Administrators are notified, and you can call the next group.

If the Administrator moves or defers the group you have **called** (but not started), every device shows a notice such as "CFD-2026-0012 was moved by …. Call the next group." Pressing Call Next clears it. A group that is already presenting cannot be changed by anyone but you.

Scheduled breaks

A room can have planned breaks (lunch, for example). The schedule places no group across a break.

Warning

While a group is up and another one would not fit before the break, every device shows a blinking red "Scheduled break at …" under the timer.

Group still presenting at break time

The Lead is asked: **Cancel Break** (no break today; continue straight on) or **Finish Group, Then Break** (the break still ends at its planned time). Doing nothing behaves like the second.

Room on break

The room shows `Break` and the controls lock. The Lead can press **End Break** to resume early; otherwise it ends by itself.

Backups and substitutions

If you sign in to a terminal for a group you are not seated on, the device asks whose seat you are taking:

You are the Backup

Choose the assigned panelist you are filling in for. The swap happens immediately; if they were the Lead, you become the Lead. They are notified.

OR

You are not on this panel

Choose the panelist you are replacing. The device shows "Waiting for an Administrator to review your request…" until an Administrator confirms or rejects it.

Until the swap is done, the group cannot be started: Start stays locked while anyone signed in to the room is not on its panel.

CHAPTER 4

Room Session Devices

Preparing the tablets or laptops that panelists use inside each room.

What a room device is

Every presentation room uses one device — usually a tablet, sometimes a laptop — **per panel seat**. Each device is one numbered **terminal**: a room with a 3-person panel has Terminals 1, 2 and 3. Panelists sign in on these devices to evaluate, and the Lead Panelist runs the room from whichever one they use.

Setting up the devices is done once per room per day, normally by an Administrator, with the room's **room account**:

Room account

Shared username and password for one room, e.g. `cfd-room101`. It only **registers a device** as a terminal. It is created when the room is started in Event Control, and deleted when the room ends — a new one is made every day.

Personal account

Each panelist's own username and password, used to sit at a terminal that is already set up.

Checking a device

Before the event, open `/room-session/device-check` on each device. It reports the browser and whether it supports what the room screens need. It needs no account, so it works even on a device that cannot get any further. Update the browser (or use another device) if it reports a problem.

> Keep devices charged and on the same reliable network. Turn off auto-lock or set it long, so the screen does not sleep mid-presentation.

Setting up a device

1. **Start the room**

   In **Event Control**, press **Start Room**. The room's card then shows its room account. Press **Reset Password** to see a password — a new one is issued and shown once each time.

2. **Open Room Session on the device**

   On the home page press **Room Session**, then sign in with the room account's username and password on **Join Room Session**.

3. **Pick the terminal number**

   "Which terminal is this device?" — choose a number and press **Set Up This Device**. A number already used by another device shows **Already set up on another device** and cannot be picked until an Administrator releases it in Event Control.

   Terminal → Claimed

4 **Hand it to the panelist**

The device now waits with a QR code and a Log In form. The panelist connects with their own account — see Joining a room terminal.

Status → Connected

The device stays set up for the rest of the day, even as panelists sign in and out. The room cannot call its first group until every terminal is connected.

The device screen

The top bar shows the system name, the **room** and the **terminal number**. Below it:

Room Queue

Today's counts, the current or last group, who is called and next, and **View All** for the full queue in a side panel.

Status card

The group on stage, its timer, payment status, break warnings and notices from the Administrator.

Connection panel

The QR code and Log In form when empty; the connected panelist and their badges otherwise.

Evaluation and controls

The evaluation sheet for the called group, and the Presentation Controls for the Lead.

Releasing a device

Log Out (panelist)

Signs the panelist out. The device stays set up for the next panelist.

Release This Device

Frees the terminal number. The device has to sign in with the room account again. Use it to swap a broken tablet.

End Room (Event Control)

Closes the room for the day and deletes its room account. Every device in it is signed out on its next refresh with “Room … has ended for the day.” A day still running at 11:00 PM ends on its own the same way. Nothing else signs a device out: it never times out from being idle.

Administrators can also **Disconnect** a panelist or release a device remotely from the room's Terminals table in Event Control.

CHAPTER 5

Administrators

Configure categories, build evaluation forms, assign panels, run the event and produce reports.

The presentation workflow

An Administrator manages everything for **one college**. A typical category runs through these stages; each module of the side menu covers one of them.

1. **Build an evaluation form**
   Evaluation Library — criteria, weights, remarks. Publish it. More
2. **Register panelists**
   Panelist Management — create their accounts. More
3. **Create and configure the category**
   Presentation Setup — project information, registration window, dates, rooms, queue, payment, evaluation form. More
4. **Groups register**
   Students register publicly while the window is open. You can also add groups yourself.
5. **The queue generates itself**
   When registration closes and setup is complete. More
6. **Assign panels**
   Group & Panel Assignment — panelists, Lead and backup for every group. More
7. **Run the event**
   Event Control — start rooms, set up devices, watch the day, end rooms. More
8. **Report**
   Reports and **Analytics** — grades, sheets, exports. Then End Category. More

Dashboard

Your college at a glance:

- **Stat strip** — Registered Groups, Presentations Done, Rooms Live, Active Panelists, Avg. Group Score and Avg. Presentation length.
- **Activity** chart — registrations and completed presentations per day (7, 14 or 30 days).
- **Presentation Outcomes**, **Queue Pipeline** and **Score Distribution** charts. Hover over a mark for its value.
- **Categories** table with status, progress and next day; **Live Rooms**, **Upcoming Days** and **Panelist Workload**.
- **Needs Attention** — everything waiting on you. See Needs Attention.

> Clicking an item in Needs Attention opens the exact page and makes the row or field to fix **blink**, so you do not have to look for it.

Panelist Management

The list of your college's panelists, with search and filters. Click a row to open its details drawer (categories, and assigned, upcoming and completed groups); its group list can be searched by group code or title.

1. ### Add Panelist

   Enter the name and choose the **Panelist Type**: **Internal** locks the Department to your college; **External** shows a Department field to type the panelist's own department. Either way the panelist is registered under your college and can sit on its panels. Edit changes the type the same way.

2. ### Copy the credentials

   The username and temporary password are shown **once**. Give them to the panelist; they must change the password on first sign-in.

ROW ACTIONS (⋮)

View / Edit

See or correct the panelist's profile.

Reset Password

Issues a new temporary password, shown once. Use it when a panelist forgets theirs.

Deactivate / Activate

Blocks or restores sign-in without deleting history.

Delete

Removes the panelist. Prefer Deactivate for anyone who has served on a panel.

Evaluation Library

Build the evaluation sheets panelists fill in. A form is drawn as the actual paper; you type directly on it.

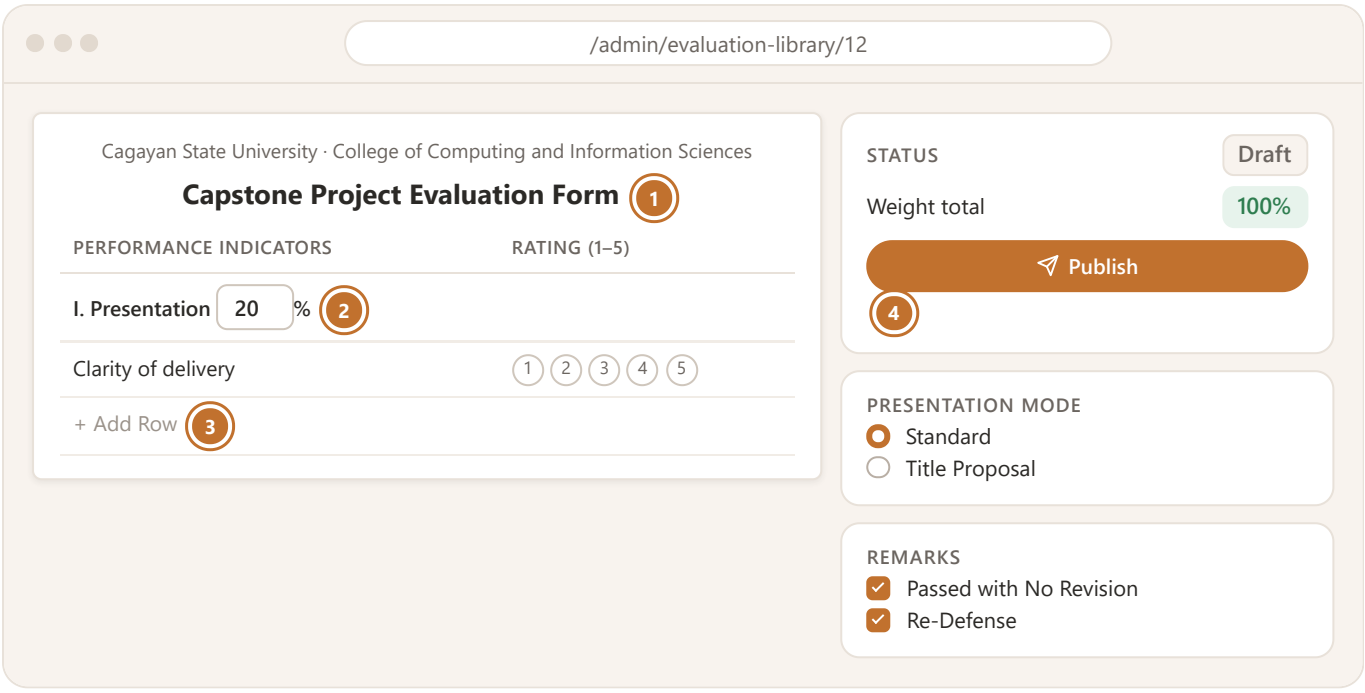


Figure 12. The form builder: the paper on the left, the tools panel on the right.

1. **Title** — click and type. Changes save when you leave the field.
2. **Sections and weights** — each section carries a percentage. All sections must total exactly **100%**.
3. **Add Row** — add a section or a criterion above or below. Hover a row to move it up/down or remove it.
4. **Tools panel** — weight total, Publish, presentation mode, letterhead on/off and which remarks (outcomes) the sheet offers.

1. **+ Add Form**
   Opens a new draft straight away.
2. **Build it**
   Sections with weights, criteria under each section (every section needs at least one), the mode, and the remarks. The rating scale is fixed at 1–5.
3. **Publish**
   Possible once the weights total 100%, every section has a criterion and a mode is chosen. Only published forms can be assigned to a category.

Editing a published form

Open it and press **Edit Form**; press **Done Editing** when finished. There are no versions — you edit the one form. Two things to know:

- A criterion that already has recorded scores **cannot be deleted**; rename it instead.
- Changing **weights** does not re-compute evaluations already submitted. Avoid re-weighting a form in the middle of an event.

Letterhead and outcomes

Letterhead sets your college's header: two logos (JPG, PNG, SVG or WEBP, up to 2 MB) and up to four text lines. It prints on every form that has its letterhead switched on, and on reports. **Manage Outcomes** lists the five presentation outcomes used as remarks — see Presentation outcomes.

Presentation Setup

Each **category** is one presentation event. The list has **Active** and **Archived** tabs; press **New Category** to create one, or a card's button to open its setup.

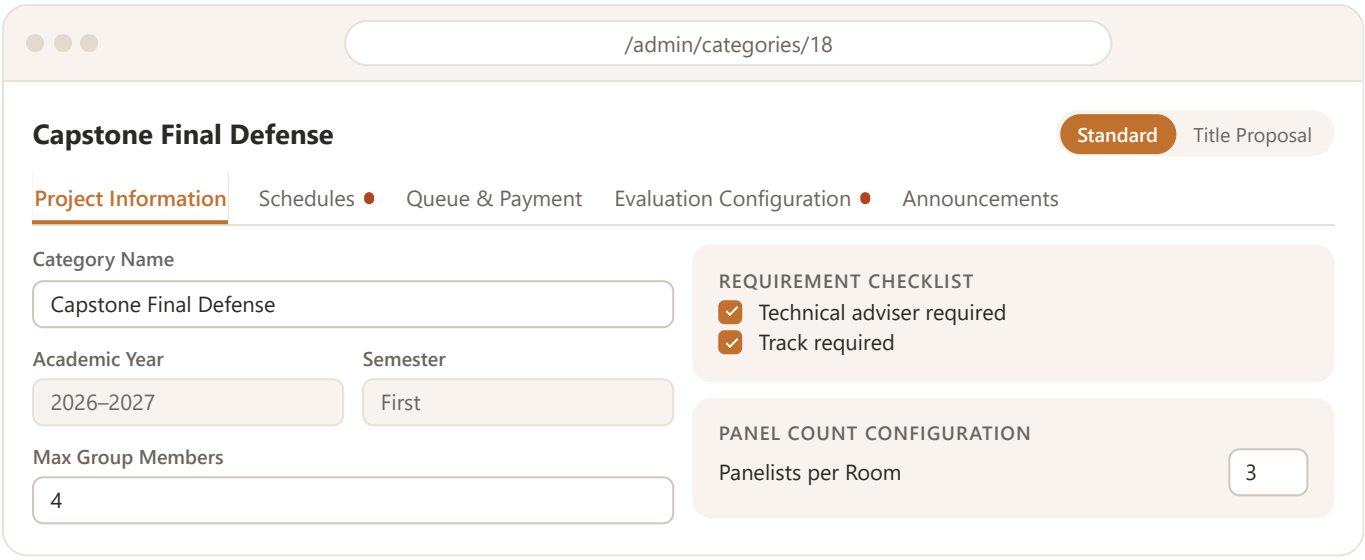


Figure 13. A category's setup. Red dots mark tabs with something still missing.

TAB	WHAT YOU SET
Project Information	Name, description, subject, presentation mode, max group members, proposed title count (Title Proposal), requirement checklist (technical adviser, track), the track list, **Panelists per Room** and whether **groups choose their panelists at registration**. Academic year, semester and college come from the active settings.
Schedules	Registration opens/closes, duration per group, presentation dates, rooms and their tracks, breaks. Details
Queue & Payment	Queue strategy, called-group waiting period, payment requirement, payment types and instructions. Details
Evaluation Configuration	Which published form panelists use. Only your college's forms for the category's mode are offered. When **Track required** is on, each track gets its own form instead. Details
Announcements	Messages shown on the public schedule page, optionally only between a start and end time.

One evaluation form per track

When the requirement checklist has **Track required** on, Evaluation Configuration lists the category's tracks in a **Track | Evaluation Form** table. Choose a form for each track and press **Assign**; several tracks may share one form. A track without a form keeps the red dot, and the category-wide form is not used.

A group gets the form of its **leader's track**, fixed when its presentation starts. Start is refused, naming the group, if it has no track, its track is not on the list, or the track has no form.

Letting groups choose their panel

Under **Panelists per Room**, tick **Groups choose their panelists at registration** (a panel count is required first). The registration form — and Add Group — then asks for a Chair and each Member from your college's active panelists.

- A group's picks are seated automatically when it is placed in the queue; the first pick is the Chair. Each seated panelist is notified.
- A pick who is busy at that time, no longer active, or the group's own adviser is skipped, and that seat is left for you to fill. The **Alternate Panel** is always yours to choose.
- Groups registered before you turned it on can choose once from the public schedule (**Select Panel**) while they have no panel.
- You can always change a group's panel with Edit Panel.

Whether or not this is on, the **Technical Adviser** field is a list of your college's panelists, and a group's adviser can never sit on its panel.

Category status

The status is worked out by the system — you never set it by hand:

Draft

No registration window yet. Hidden from students.

Upcoming

Registration opens later. Listed publicly.

Registration Open

Students can register.

Setup Incomplete

Registration closed but something is still missing (red dots) — the queue waits.

Awaiting Groups

Registration closed and setup complete, but no group has registered yet.

Queue Generated

Registration closed, setup complete and the queue has been built.

Completed

Ended with **End Category**. Setup becomes view only.

Archived

Put away with **Archive**. Hidden from students and from the working modules; **Unarchive** brings it back.

Once any day of the category has started, the **presentation mode can no longer be changed**.

Dates, rooms, tracks and breaks

Registration window and duration

Set **Registration Opens** and **Registration Closes**, and the **Duration per Group** in minutes. Groups are scheduled back to back with no gap.

Adding presentation dates

1. **Add Presentation Dates**
   Start Date, End Date, Daily Start Time, Daily End Time and, optionally, a daily Break Start/End Time. One date is created for every day in the range (up to 60). Re-running a range only adds missing days.
2. **Include Saturday and Sunday?**
   If the range has weekend days you are asked. **No** removes them.
3. **Assign rooms**
   Tick rooms and days, then **Assign to Selected Days**. You can register a new room right there.

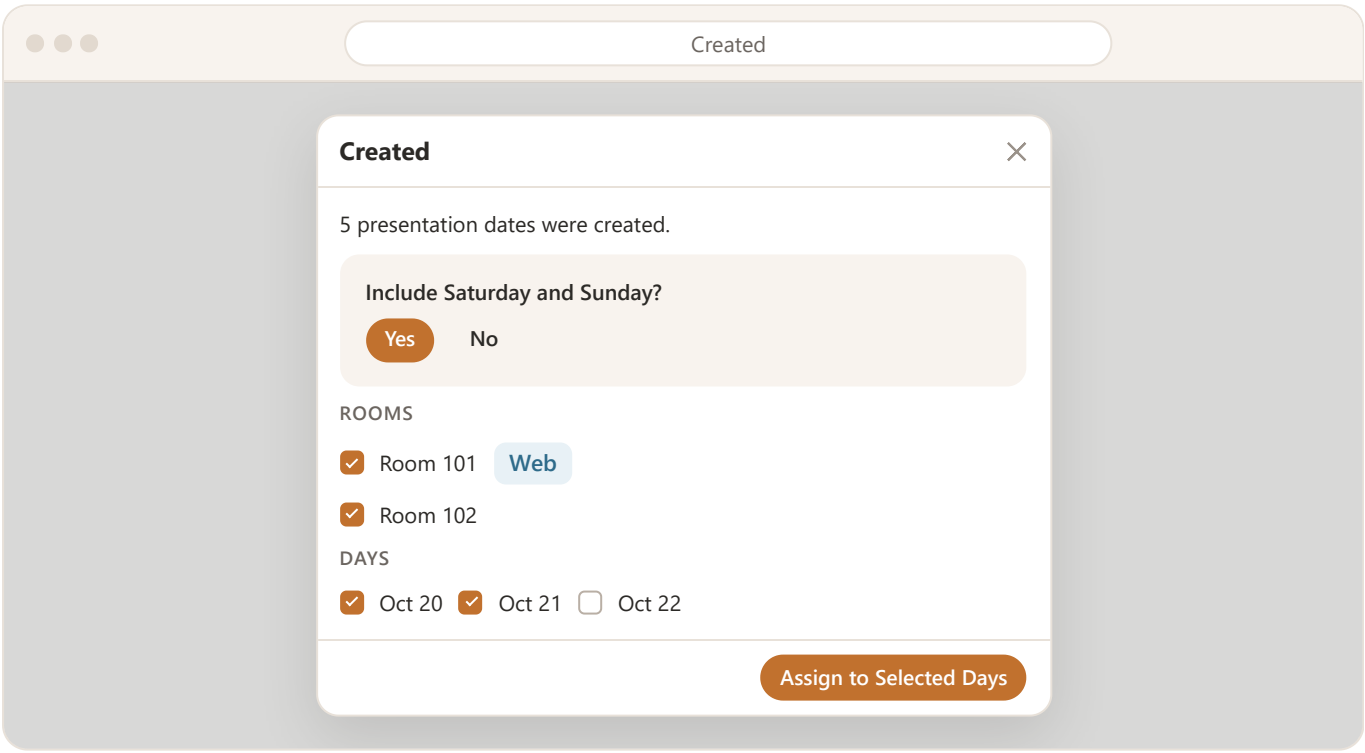


Figure 14. After saving a date range: the weekend question, then room assignment.

Rooms

Rooms are typed in, not picked from a fixed list. **Register Room** adds a room name to the category; the panel size comes from **Panelists per Room**. A room only takes part on the days it is assigned to. Use **Edit Room** to rename it or change its tracks; the per-day × removes it from one day.

Tracks

If **Track required** is on and you list tracks in Project Information, students pick a track at registration and you can limit a room to certain tracks when registering it. Track rooms are **strict**:

- A room limited to tracks only ever takes groups of those tracks.
- A room with no tracks takes groups with no track, or with a track no room serves.
- A group with nowhere to go waits as `To be scheduled` until a suitable room exists.

Breaks

A daily break set on the date range is copied to every room as it is assigned. To add or remove a break for one day, open the day's **Edit** and use **Break Periods** (one room, or **All rooms**). Groups after a break move automatically.

Editing and removing a date

- **Edit** a day's date and times, including a day that came and went without starting (`Overdue`) — it cannot be started until you move it.
- **Remove Date** moves that day's groups to another open room on their track; a date with a completed presentation on it cannot be removed.
- **Removing a room** from a day (or deleting it from the room list) moves the groups queued in it to the rooms still in use: the same day first, then the next day with time, in queue order. A group you placed by hand keeps its time.
- A finished day can take a **second session**: if every room ended early, add a new date range for the same day.
- When you add a date earlier than the one groups are waiting on, they are pulled forward to the nearest open day.

Queue strategy and payment

First In, First Out
Groups present in the order they registered.

Section Based
Groups together by section. Type a **Section Order** (e.g. 4C, 4A) or leave it empty for A–Z; unlisted sections follow.

Random Draw
A fair, recorded random order. The same draw is kept every time the queue is rebuilt; a late group lands at a random spot. Saving another strategy discards the draw.

Called-Group Waiting Period is how many minutes a called group has to appear.

Payment

Tick **Payment verification required**, add one or more **Payment Types** (e.g. "Defense Fee", "Documentation Fee") and write the **Verification Instructions** students will read. The Lead Panelist must verify every type, by reference number, before a group can start. Reference numbers are unique across the whole system.

How the queue is generated

There is no Generate button. The queue builds itself the first time registration is closed and setup is complete (no red dots) and has at least one group. Then:

- Groups are ordered by the chosen strategy.
- Days are filled in date order. Within a day, groups are dealt **round-robin** across that day's rooms, so rooms run in parallel; the next day is used only when the day is full.
- Each room only takes groups its tracks accept.
- Groups that do not fit anywhere are kept as `To be scheduled` — add a date or room and they are placed.

Changing the **strategy** or the **Section Order** before any day has started rebuilds the whole queue — and removes moves, deferrals and panels already assigned, so settle the strategy first. Saving the Queue tab without changing either leaves the queue as it is. Changing **tracks or rooms** rebuilds only while nothing has been moved, deferred or given a panel; after that, groups are re-placed without touching their panels.

Groups registered after the queue exists

A late registration — from a student or from **Add Group** — is fitted into the queue as it stands. Nothing is rebuilt, so your moves, transfers, deferrals and panels stay. Where it goes follows the strategy:

- **First In, First Out** — after the last group already queued, ahead of groups deferred to the end of the queue. Groups always present in **registration order**: after any automatic change (a late or re-queued group, a date added or removed, a spill to the next day), groups on days that have not started are put back in that order and only their times and dates change. Groups you moved, transferred, deferred or reinserted keep the place you gave them.
- **Section Based** — at the end of its section, in the room that reaches that point first. Groups pushed past closing time move to the next day, ahead of that day's groups of the same section. Within a section, groups always present in **registration order**: after any automatic change (a late or re-queued group, a date added or removed, a spill to the next day), the section's groups on days that have not started are put back in that order. Groups you moved, transferred, deferred or reinserted keep the place you gave them.
- **Random Draw** — a random place among the groups still to present.
- It is **never** placed on a day that has already started: it goes to the next day that has not, or waits as `To be scheduled` if there is none. You can still Transfer it onto a running day yourself.

The **Capacity Analysis** card on the Schedules tab shows whether the remaining days and rooms can hold every group.

Group & Panel Assignment

The working list of every group in a category. Use **Category** at the top right to switch categories.

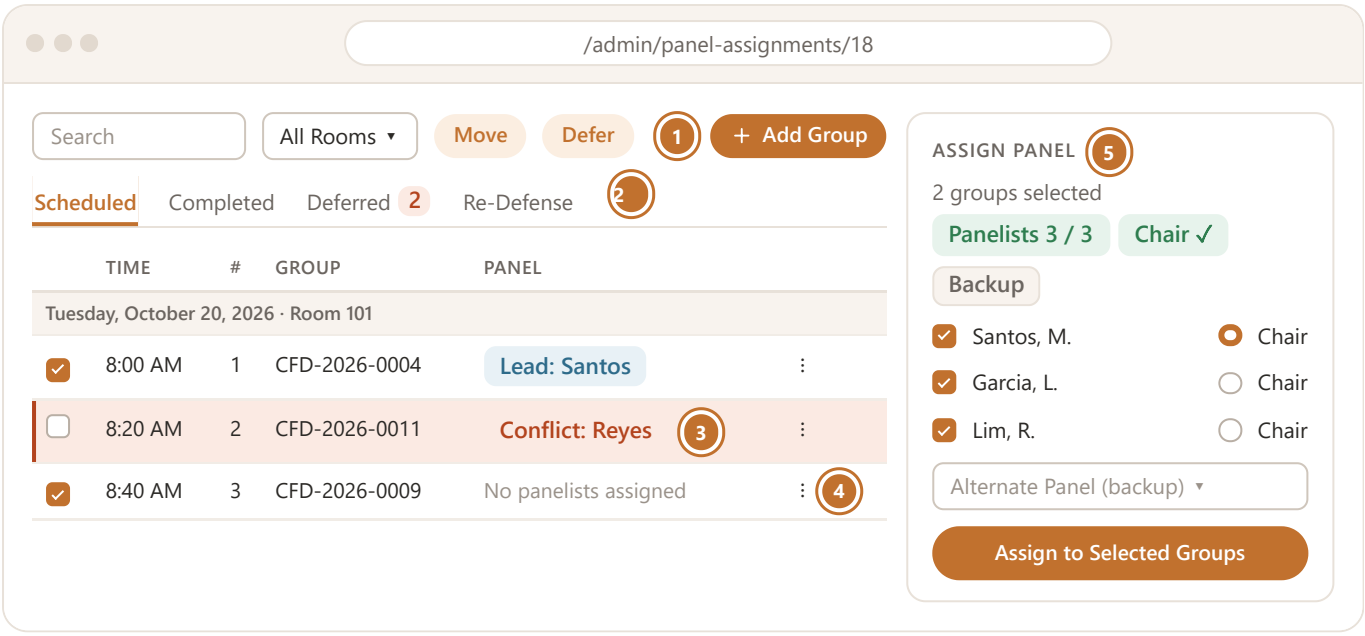


Figure 15. Group & Panel Assignment.

1. **Toolbar** — search (leader, title, group code), room filter, bulk actions for ticked groups, and Add Group.
2. **Tabs** — Scheduled, Completed, Deferred and Re-Defense. Rows are grouped by day and room.
3. **Red row** — a panelist on this group is double-booked. Hover for details; click the row to replace that panelist.
4. **Row menu (⋮)** — Edit, Edit Panel, Move, Transfer, Defer, Delete.
5. **Assign Panel** — choose the panel for every ticked group at once.

Adding and editing groups

Add Group registers a group with the same form students use — handy for late or walk-in registrations — and places it in the queue by the category's strategy — see Groups registered after the queue exists. **Edit** corrects a registration (names, members, titles, track, adviser) without moving it; the adviser must be chosen from the list. Edit does not change the panel — use Edit Panel. Changing a group's section does not re-place it; Move or Transfer it afterwards if needed.

Assigning panels

1. **Tick the groups**
   Usually a whole room's day. All ticked groups must need the same panel size.
2. **Tick exactly the required number of panelists**
   The required number is **Panelists per Room**.
3. **Pick the Chair (Lead)**
   One of the ticked panelists. The Chair runs the room and gives the official outcome.
4. **Pick the Alternate Panel (backup)**
   Exactly one backup, not one of the seated panelists.
5. **Assign to Selected Groups**
   If a ticked group already has a panel, you are asked to confirm replacing it. Panelists are notified.

⚠ A panelist cannot be in two places at once. Assigning someone whose time overlaps another of their groups — in any category of your college — is refused and names the clash. Only your own college's panelists can be assigned, and a group's own technical adviser can never sit on its panel.

Editing one group's panel

Choose **Edit Panel** in a group's ⋮ menu. The Assign Panel card switches to **Edit Panel · {group code}** with that group's current panel ticked. Change the members, Chair or Alternate (optional here) and press **Save Panel**; **Cancel** returns to normal. Only the panelists you change are replaced — the others keep their seats — and the same conflict and adviser checks apply.

Substitution requests

When a panelist marks themselves unavailable, or someone at a room device asks to take a seat, it appears in **Needs Attention**. Confirm or Reject a seat request; for an unavailability report, choose the replacement with **Assign Replacement**.

Editing, moving and deferring groups

Move
Change a group's position within its room. The list shows the room's order; already-presented positions cannot be taken. In a **Section Based** category a group can only move within its own section — the list shows each row's section and the positions available, e.g. "Section 4B · positions 4–5 available".

Transfer
Send to another room or day — ongoing or upcoming only, and only a room that accepts the group's track. In a **Section Based** category it lands at the end of its section in that room, and only days that keep the sections in order are offered; otherwise it lands at the end of that room.

Defer
Take the group out of the active queue, with a reason. It appears under Deferred.

Reinsert
Put a deferred group back, at any position you choose — the strategy does not restrict it. In a payment category you can **Verify Payment** for it first.

Delete
Removes the group's place in the queue (its registration stays). Refused once evaluations exist.

Every action works on one row (⋮) or on all ticked rows (toolbar). Times recalculate automatically, panelists are told when their groups move, and panel conflicts are re-checked.

DURING A RUNNING DAY

Ongoing / Paused

Untouchable — no checkbox, no menu. Only the Lead can defer it.

Called

Can be changed. The room is told to call the next group.

Completed

Never moves.

Day already over

The group can only be Transferred to an open day.

Re-defense

When a group's official outcome is Re-Defense, it appears under the **Re-Defense** tab with every attempt, its date, outcome and **View Evaluation**. Press **Reinsert** and confirm to schedule the next attempt. A re-defense always presents after every group still waiting for its first attempt, including groups that register after it was reinserted; if there is no time left after them, it waits as To be scheduled.

- The new attempt goes to the **last open day**, in the room that finishes last, at the **end of the queue** — and stays last even when other groups are added.
- It starts **without a panel**; assign one as usual. The earlier attempt's panel and scores are kept as history.
- A Failed group never gets another attempt; it must register again.

Event Control

Run the presentation days. The page shows the featured day (today's, or the next one) with a tab per room; **View All Days** lists the rest.

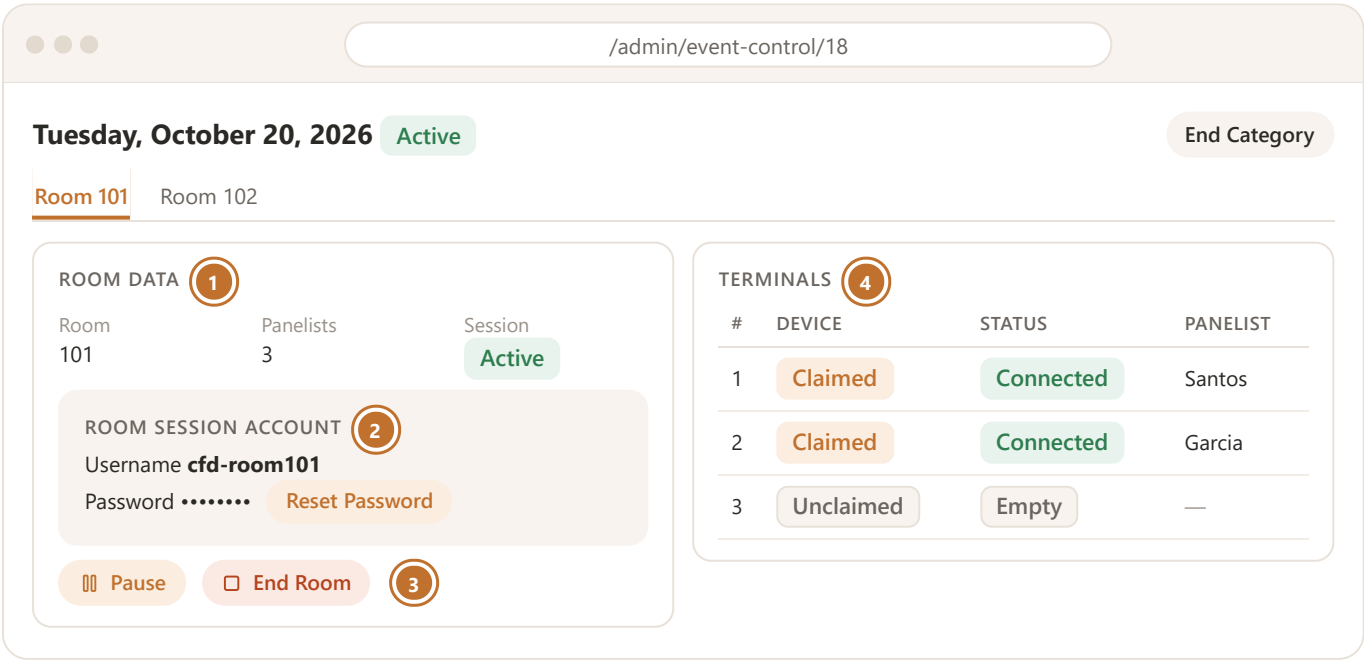


Figure 16. A room in Event Control.

1. **Room Data** — room, panel size, session status, start time, today's counts and the full queue (View All).
2. **Room Session Account** — for setting up the room's devices. Reset Password shows a new one.
3. **Start Room / Pause / Resume / End Room**.
4. **Terminals** — which devices are set up and who is connected, with Disconnect and Release Device. The ⓘ button explains them.

1. ▷ **Start Room**

   Available on the day, once its planned time arrives. The first room started makes the day Active. Each room creates its terminals and room account.

2. **Set up the devices**

   See Setting up a device. From then on the Lead Panelist runs the room.

3. **Pause if needed**

   An emergency stop for the whole room, available at any time.

4. **End Room**

   When the room is done. Refused while a group is presenting. The confirmation lists groups still queued in it.

How a day and a category end

- A day ends when **every room** on it has been started and ended. If you forget, it ends automatically at 11:00 PM.
- At the end of a day, unfinished groups move to the **front** of the next day, in the same room if it is used that day, otherwise shared out over the rooms the next day uses, in the order they had, and deferred groups go to the **end** of the category's queue. With no later day they wait as "To be scheduled" — add a date.
- A day that was never started is **cancelled** after it passes, and its groups move on the same way.
- **End Category** (Event Control) closes the category once no group still has to present (a pending re-defense blocks it). Nothing is deleted; registration and new dates stop.
- An ended category can then be archived in Presentation Setup, or deleted from Event Control.

Reports

Generated Grades lists every student of the category's graded groups:

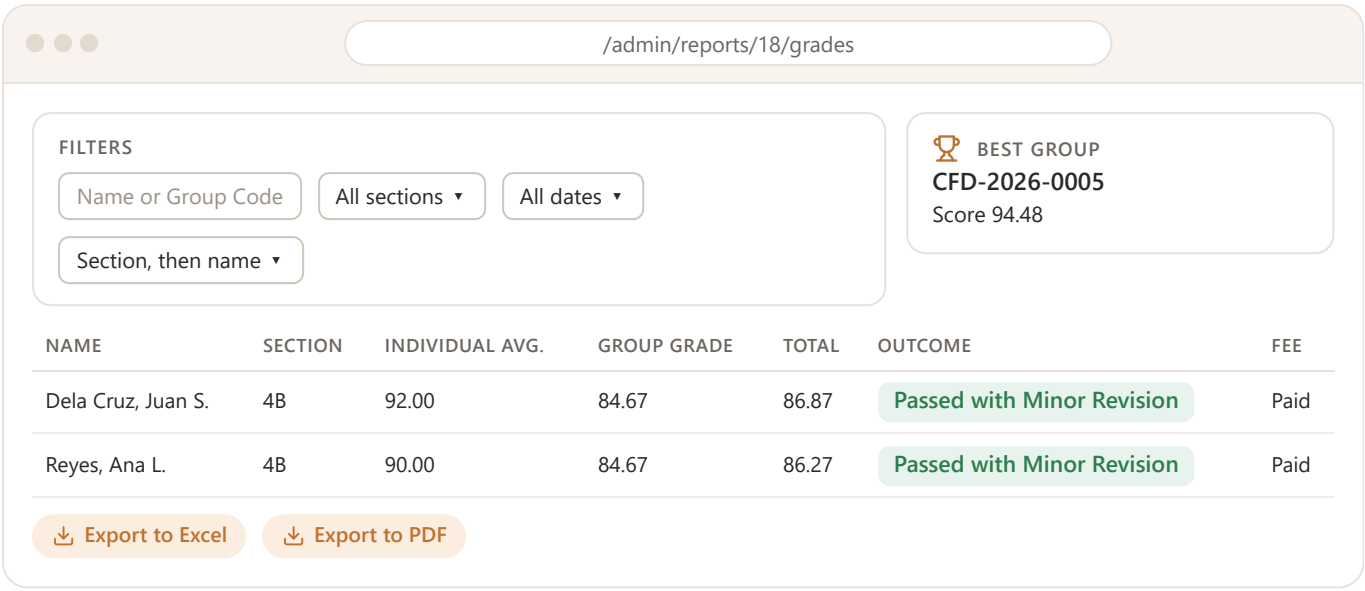


Figure 17. Generated Grades.

- **Filters** — name or group code (a code shows every member of that group), section, presentation date, and sort (section then name, or last name). Exports follow the filters.
- **Export to Excel / PDF** — opens a list of columns to tick. Name, Section and Track are always included; everything else (group, grades, remarks, attempt, each payment) is ticked by default and can be left out.
- **Evaluation** — view the evaluation sheets the panel submitted for a group.
- **Best Group** (Group Grade × 70% + the members' average Individual Grade × 30%) and **Best Presenter** (Group Grade × 30% + their own Individual Grade × 70%) — the category's leaders; **View** shows the top five, one per row, with its own **Track** and **Section** dropdowns (default: all) and exportable to PDF. The grades filters are hidden while it is open.
- **Panelist Sign-off Sheet** — every panelist and how many groups they evaluated, with signature lines. View, print or export to PDF at any time.
- **Recommendations Summary** — the panel's remarks and comments per group, viewable and exportable. Each group in the list has **Print** and **Export to PDF** for its own Recommendation Form (title, researchers, defense date, numbered recommendations and the panel's sign-off).
- Groups awaiting a re-defense are left out until their final attempt; Failed groups appear, marked in red.

How the numbers are computed is explained in How scores and grades are computed.

Analytics

Compares the **planned** schedule with what **actually happened**, across all categories or one: presentations measured, median duration against the configured slot, hours used of hours booked, room utilization, days run, and time from call to start. When there is enough data it **recommends a slot length** (based on the 90th percentile, so almost every group fits) with a link to change it in Presentation Setup.

> Only presentations run on a room device are measured; cancelled or never-started days are ignored. Each figure shows how many presentations it is based on.

Needs Attention

The dashboard's Needs Attention card (and the chip on Group & Panel Assignment) collects:

ITEM	WHAT TO DO
Substitution request	Confirm or Reject the proposed seat swap.
Panelist unavailable	Assign a replacement on the group.
Panel schedule conflict	Replace the double-booked panelist (click the red row).
Group deferred	Review the deferred group and reinsert it.
Groups waiting, no open date	Add a presentation date or room.
Presentation date overdue	Edit the date — a past, never-started day cannot be started.
Day could not end	A presentation is still running in a room; complete or defer it.

CHAPTER 6

Super Administrators

Accounts, institutional settings, audit trail, backups and system health.

Dashboard

System-wide totals (accounts, panelists, active categories, audit events today), an audit activity chart and the most recent audit entries. **View All** opens the full Audit Log.

Admin Accounts

Only the Super Administrator creates Administrator accounts. Each Administrator manages exactly one **college**, chosen here — it decides every category, panelist and form they can see.

1. **New Admin Account**
   Username, name, the college, and optionally contact number, email and employee reference.
2. **Copy the temporary password**
   A 12-character password is generated and shown **once**. The Administrator must change it at first sign-in.

ROW ACTIONS

View / Edit

Correct details or move the Administrator to another college.

Reset Password

Issues a new temporary password, shown once.

Deactivate / Activate

Blocks or restores sign-in. Their college's data is untouched.

Delete

Removes the account. Prefer Deactivate to keep history.

Panelist Oversight

A **view-only** list of every panelist in every college, with their college, department and assignment history. Panelists are created and edited by their college's Administrator, not here.

Application Settings

Open from **Settings** → **Application Settings**. Four tabs of reference data, each with View, Edit, Activate/Deactivate (or Set Active) and Delete:

TAB	NOTES
Campuses	Code and name.
Colleges	Each Administrator, category, panelist, evaluation form and letterhead belongs to one. A college in use cannot be deleted.
Academic Years	**Exactly one is active.** New categories and panelist passwords use it. Change it only with **Set Active**; the active one cannot be deactivated or deleted.
Semesters	Exactly one is active, with the same rules.

⚠ Switch the active academic year and semester at the start of a new term, before Administrators create that term's categories. Existing categories keep the year they were created in.

Security Settings

Three cards, each saved on its own. Nothing is set until you set it; a blank field keeps the built-in behaviour.

- **Login Lockout** — after the set number of wrong passwords in a row, the account cannot sign in for the set number of minutes, even with the right password. It unlocks by itself after that, or at once when an Administrator (or you, for an Administrator) uses **Reset Password**. Applies to Administrators and Panelists, including a panelist's sign-in on a room session device. Super Admin accounts are never locked. Blank = no lockout.
- **Session Timeout** — minutes without activity before a signed-in user is signed out. Blank = the server's default (usually 120). A page that refreshes itself in the background, such as a panelist's open dashboard, counts as activity. Room session devices are never signed out by this setting: a claimed tablet stays signed in, even when it sits idle or asleep for hours, until its room is ended (End Room, or the day ending on its own at 11:00 PM).
- **Password Rules** — the minimum length and the characters a new password must contain (uppercase, lowercase, number, symbol), checked whenever someone changes their password; the Change Password page lists the current rules. **Password expires after** forces everyone whose password is older than that many days to choose a new one at their next sign-in. Blank = never expires. The default rule is 8+ characters with an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter and a number.

Every change is recorded in the Audit Log as `SECURITY_SETTING_UPDATED`, with the old and new values.

Audit Log

A read-only record of important actions — who did what, when and to which record. Filter by text, user, action, record type and date range. **Export CSV** downloads the filtered entries, including the values before and after (the export itself is recorded). Old entries can be pruned automatically — see Health and maintenance.

Backups

Backup & Maintenance has three tabs: Backups, Health and Maintenance. A backup is one `.zip` with the whole database and the uploaded letterhead logos.

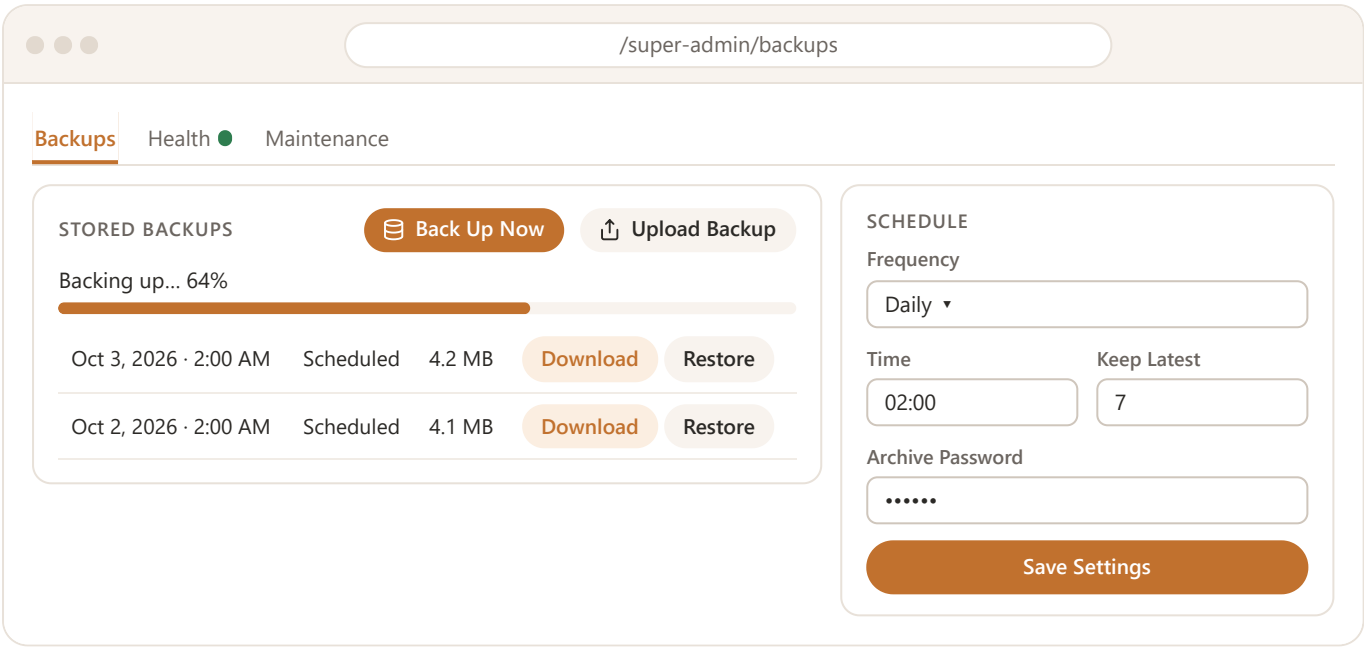


Figure 18. Backup & Maintenance — Backups tab.

- **Back Up Now** — runs a backup with a progress bar. Keep the page open until it finishes; if interrupted it picks up where it stopped.
- **Schedule** — Off, Daily or Weekly at a set time, keeping the newest N backups. Scheduled backups need the server's scheduled task (cron) to be running.
- **Archive Password** — optional; encrypts each archive. Without it a backup cannot be restored, so store it safely.
- **Download** — keep a copy off the server regularly. Backups are never public.
- **Upload Backup** — add an archive made elsewhere, for example to move to a new server.

Restoring a backup

> ⚠ **A restore replaces all current data** with the backup's. Everything entered after the backup was taken is lost.

1. **Press Restore on the backup**
   Enter the archive password if it has one, and type `RESTORE` to continue.
2. **The archive is checked first**
   A damaged, wrong-password or newer-version archive is refused before anything changes.
3. **The site closes and a safety backup is taken**
   Everyone else sees a "restoring" page. A backup of the current data is made first, so the restore itself can be undone.

4 **Data is replaced, then the site reopens**

Keep the tab open. If it is closed, reopening the site continues it. If a restore fails, the site stays in Maintenance mode for you to check.

Health and maintenance

Health tab

A traffic-light check of the system: scheduled tasks running, age of the last backup, last restore, free disk space, pending updates, last maintenance run, log size, maintenance mode and server configuration. The tab carries a coloured dot for the worst result.

Maintenance tab

Maintenance Mode

Turn On to close the site to everyone except Super Administrators, with a message to visitors. **Turn Off** to reopen.

Routine Cleanup

Runs daily, or now with **Run Now**: clears expired sessions and temporary files, rotates the application log, and prunes audit entries older than your setting.

If you are locked out by maintenance mode, a server administrator can turn it off with `php artisan maintenance:mode off`.

CHAPTER 7

Reference

Statuses, outcomes, grade computation, permissions and terms in one place.

Status reference

A GROUP'S PRESENTATION

Scheduled / Queued

Placed in a room and waiting.

Called

The Lead called the group; it should come in now.

Ongoing

Presenting; the timer runs.

Paused

Timer stopped for an interruption.

Completed

Presented and evaluated, with an outcome.

Deferred

Set aside with a reason; will be reinserted.

To be scheduled

Still to present, but has no usable slot — waiting for a date or room.

A PRESENTATION DAY

Planned

Ahead; its start time has not come yet.

Standby

Its time has come; waiting for the first Start Room.

Active

At least one room started; the day is running.

Completed

Every room ended (or it ended automatically at 11:00 PM).

Cancelled

Passed without ever being started.

Overdue

Its window passed unstarted; edit the date to use it.

A ROOM ON THE DAY

Waiting

Started; no group on stage right now.

Active

A group is called or presenting.

Paused

Paused by an Administrator.

Break

Inside a scheduled break with nobody on stage.

Closed

Ended for the day.

A TERMINAL

Unclaimed

No device set up as this terminal.

Claimed

A device is set up as this terminal.

Empty

No panelist is signed in on it.

Connected

A panelist is signed in on it.

PAYMENT

Verified / Paid

Reference number recorded by the Lead or an Administrator.

Unpaid

Not verified yet. A partly verified group shows e.g. "1/2 Verified".

Presentation outcomes

Remarks are not picked by the panel. When a panelist submits, their sheet's remark is marked from its Total Score; the group's official outcome comes from its **Group Grade** (the average Total Score of all submitted sheets), rounded off to a whole percent (90.5 counts as 91): 91–100% Passed with No Revision, 81–90% Passed with Minor Revision, 71–80% Passed with Major Revision, 61–70% Re-Defense, below 61% Failed. Title Proposal sheets still have the remark picked, and the Lead Panelist's pick is the official outcome.

OUTCOME	SUCCESSFUL	ANOTHER ATTEMPT	IN GRADE REPORTS
Passed with No Revision	**Yes**	No	Yes
Passed with Minor Revision	**Yes**	No	Yes
Passed with Major Revision	**Yes**	No	Yes

OUTCOME	SUCCESSFUL	ANOTHER ATTEMPT	IN GRADE REPORTS
Re-Defense	Not yet	**Yes — presents again last**	No, until the final attempt
Failed	No	No — must register again	Yes, marked red

How scores and grades are computed

1. **Section score**
   The average of the section's criterion ratings, out of 5, turned into a percentage: `average ÷ 5 × 100`.
2. **One panelist's total score**
   Each section score times its weight, added up — out of 100. This is the "Total Score" on the sheet.
3. **Group Grade**
   The average of every panelist's total score for the group.
4. **Individual Grade Average**
   The average of the individual scores (0–100) each panelist gave that student.
5. **Total**
   `30% × Individual Grade Average + 70% × Group Grade`.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Sections: Presentation 20%, Functionality 30%, Documentation 50%. One panelist rates them 4.5, 4.0 and 4.2 on average.

Sections

90% × 0.20 + 80% × 0.30 + 84% × 0.50 = 18 + 24 + 42 = **84.00**

Group Grade

Panel totals 84.00, 86.00, 84.00 → **84.67**

Individual Avg.

Panel gave the student 92, 90, 94 → **92.00**

Total

0.30 × 92.00 + 0.70 × 84.67 = **86.87**

Title Proposal forms have no totals or individual scores; their result is the approved title and the outcome. If a group presented more than once, its latest completed attempt is the one graded.

Who can do what

TASK	STUDENT	PANELIST	ADMIN	SUPER ADMIN
Register a group	✓	—	**✓ (Add Group)**	—

TASK	STUDENT	PANELIST	ADMIN	SUPER ADMIN
Choose the group's panel	**✓ (if the category allows, once)**	—	**✓ (Assign / Edit Panel)**	—
Follow advised groups and their evaluations	—	**✓ (own advisees)**	✓	—
Edit a registration	—	—	✓	—
View schedule and queue	✓	✓	✓	—
Evaluate a group	—	**✓ (seated)**	—	—
Call, start, complete, defer	—	**✓ (Lead)**	Defer / override	—
Create panelist accounts	—	—	✓	View only
Categories, forms, panels, event day	—	—	**✓ (own college)**	—
Reports and analytics	—	—	✓	—
Administrator accounts, colleges, school year	—	—	—	✓
Audit log, backups, maintenance	—	—	—	✓

Glossary

Advisee

A group that names a panelist as its technical adviser. Listed in that panelist's My Advisees.

Attempt

One presentation by a group. A re-defense is the group's second (or later) attempt.

Backup / Alternate Panel

The standby panelist who can take an assigned seat.

Category

One presentation event, e.g. "Capstone Final Defense", with its own registration, dates, rooms and form.

Chair / Lead Panelist

The panelist who runs the room (in Title Proposal, also picks the official outcome).

College

The unit an Administrator manages; categories, panelists and forms belong to it.

Defer

Take a group out of the active queue for now, with a reason.

Evaluation form

The rating sheet: weighted sections of criteria rated 1–5, plus remarks.

Expected time

A live estimate of when a group will present, while its day runs.

Group reference

A group's ID, e.g. CFD-2026-0012.

Outcome / Remark

The verdict on a presentation (Pass…, Re-Defense, Failed).

Planned time

The slot the schedule assigned before the day started.

Presentation mode

Standard (one project) or Title Proposal (several proposed titles).

Queue strategy

How groups are ordered: First In First Out, Section Based or Random Draw.

Reinsert

Put a deferred group back in a queue.

Room account

A room's shared, day-only login used to set up its devices.

Technical adviser

The panelist who advises a group, chosen from a list at registration. Never sits on that group's panel.

Terminal

One numbered device seat in a room, one per panelist.

Track

A research area (e.g. Web, Mobile). Track rooms only take their tracks' groups.

Transfer

Move a group to another room or day.

CHAPTER 8

FAQ & Troubleshooting

Answers to the questions users ask most, grouped by topic.

Accounts and signing in

Q I forgot my password. How do I reset it?

There is no self-service reset. Panelists ask their Administrator (**Panelist Management** → **Reset Password**); Administrators ask the Super Administrator (**Admin Accounts** → **Reset Password**). You receive a new temporary password and must change it when you sign in.

Q I never received my username or password.

Credentials are shown once, to whoever created your account. Ask them to reset your password to issue a new temporary one.

Q Why am I sent to Change Password every time I sign in?

You are still using a temporary password. Complete the Change Password form once — the rest of the system unlocks afterwards. This applies to panelists too.

Q The sign-in page says my account is inactive.

Your account was deactivated. Contact your Administrator (panelists) or the Super Administrator (administrators).

Q Can I change my username?

No. You can correct your name and contact number in **Settings**, but the username stays fixed.

Q Do students need an account?

No. Registration and schedules are public. Students never sign in.

Q Can I be signed in on my phone and a room device at the same time?

Yes. Your personal account and a room device are separate. Log out of the room device with its own Log Out button when you leave.

Registration and schedules

Q The Register button is disabled.

Registration is not open: it either opens later (the card says when) or has closed. Late groups can be added by the Administrator.

Q **I made a mistake in our registration. Can I fix it?**

Not yourself — registrations cannot be edited after submitting. Ask the Administrator to correct it. **Do not register again**; a second registration with the same leader or title is refused.

Q **It says "An active registration with matching information already exists".**

Your group (same leader name, or the same project title in Standard mode) is already registered in this category. Search for it on the schedule page.

Q **Why is my section rejected?**

Enter only the year level and a letter, like `4B` — no program name.

Q **I lost our group reference.**

Open the category's schedule and search your leader's name or project title. The group status card shows everything, including the reference.

Q **Our adviser is not in the Technical Adviser list.**

The list holds your college's active panelists. Ask your Administrator to register your adviser as a panelist.

Q **Can we change the panel we chose?**

Not yourselves — the choice is made once. Ask your Administrator; they can change it with Edit Panel.

Q **Why is one of our chosen panelists missing from our panel?**

They were busy at your time slot (or are no longer active), so that seat was left for the Administrator to fill.

Q **When will we know our schedule?**

After registration closes and the Administrator finishes setup, the queue is generated automatically. Check the schedule page.

Q **Our time keeps changing. Why?**

While the day runs, times are live estimates that follow how fast the room is actually going. Come early; a group ahead may finish early.

Q Our date, room or place in the queue changed. Why?

The schedule keeps itself up to date. A group can move when the Administrator moves or transfers it; when a date or room is added, changed or removed (groups always go to the nearest open day); when a day runs out of time and its last groups move to the next day; when a day ends with groups unfinished (they go first the next day); or, in a First In, First Out or Section Based category, when groups are put back in registration order — a group that registered before you (in Section Based, one of your section) takes the slot ahead of you. Your panel moves with you. Search your group again before your day.

Q Our group shows "To be scheduled".

You still have to present, but there is no open day, room or time slot for you yet (for example, no date has been set). Your place in the queue order is kept; you are placed as soon as the Administrator adds one.

Q We were deferred. What happens now?

You stay in the system. The Deferred list shows why. The Administrator reinserts you, or you are moved to the end of the queue at the end of the day.

Q We got Re-Defense. Do we register again?

No. The Administrator schedules your next attempt; it comes after every other group.

Q We Failed. Can we present again?

Yes, by registering again as a new group in the same or a later category.

Q Our payment reference number was refused.

Each reference number can be recorded only once in the whole system. Check you typed it correctly and that it is not another group's receipt.

Panelists and room devices

Q Call Next is disabled.

Every terminal in the room must have a panelist connected, the room must not be on a break, and nobody may already be called or presenting. Hover over the button to see which.

Q Start is disabled.

A group must be called first. Then every payment type must be verified (in a payment category), every seat must have a panelist signed in, and every panelist signed in must be on this group's panel — an unassigned panelist must log out or have a replacement approved by an Administrator, and a backup must take a seat first. Start is also locked during a break. Point at the button to see the reason.

Q **Complete is disabled.**

Every connected panelist must submit their evaluation first.

Q **I submitted my evaluation with a mistake.**

Submitted evaluations are final. Tell your Administrator.

Q **I don't see the Presentation Controls.**

Only the Lead Panelist (Chair) of the room's groups gets them, on whichever device they sign in to. Check your role in My Assignments.

Q **The QR code will not scan.**

Make sure your phone is signed in to your own panelist account, give the browser camera permission, and wait for the code to refresh. Or use **Log In Directly** on the device.

Q **"This terminal seat is already occupied."**

Another panelist is signed in on it. Ask them to log out, or ask an Administrator to Disconnect it from Event Control.

Q **"You are already connected to another seat in this room."**

Log out of your other terminal first; one panelist, one seat.

Q **The device asks for a room username, not mine.**

It has not been set up yet (or was released). An Administrator signs it in with the room account — see Setting up a device.

Q **A panelist on my panel did not come. What do I do?**

Their backup signs in to a terminal and picks the seat they are filling. Without a backup, another panelist can sign in and request the seat; an Administrator confirms it.

Q **What does "Evaluated" on my dashboard mean?**

How many evaluation sheets you submitted, across all your categories, out of the groups on your panel that have already presented. Backup seats are not counted.

Q **Where can I see the groups I advise?**

In **My Advisees** — upcoming groups with their panel, and completed ones with the panel's evaluation sheets.

Q **I cannot attend one of my assigned groups.**

Use **Mark Unavailable** in My Assignments, and tell your Administrator directly if it is today.

Q **The device warned "Scheduled break at ...".**

The next group would run into the room's break. If the current group is still on when the break comes, the Lead chooses Cancel Break or Finish Group, Then Break.

Administration

Q **The queue has not been generated.**

It generates when registration has **closed**, setup has no red dots (dates, rooms, panel count, queue strategy, evaluation form) and at least one group exists. Open Presentation Setup to see what is missing.

Q **Some groups say "To be scheduled".**

The days and rooms are full, or no room accepts their track. Add a date, a room, or a room for that track; they are placed automatically.

Q **Assign Panel is refused with a conflict.**

A chosen panelist already sits on another group at an overlapping time (any category of your college). Choose someone else, or move one of the groups.

Q **Assign Panel is refused because of the adviser.**

A group's technical adviser can never sit on its panel. Pick another panelist for that group.

Q **How do I change just one group's panel?**

Use **Edit Panel** in the group's ⋮ menu. Only the panelists you change are replaced.

Q **Why can't I Move a group?**

It is presenting, has already presented, is a pending re-defense (always last), or its day is over (use Transfer). In a Section Based category it can also only move within its own section.

Q **Transfer does not offer a day I want.**

In a Section Based category, only days that keep the sections in order are offered. The room must also accept the group's track.

Q A group's schedule moved but nobody moved it.

Groups are re-placed automatically when a date or room is added, edited or removed (they go to the nearest open day); when a break or a shorter day pushes groups past closing time (they move to the next day); when a day ends with groups unfinished (front of the next day) or deferred (end of the queue); and, in a First In, First Out or Section Based category, when groups are put back in registration order (within each section for Section Based). Groups you moved, transferred, deferred or reinserted keep their place. Their panelists get a "Schedule changed" notification.

Q Where does a group that registers late go?

It is fitted into the existing queue by the strategy, never on a day that has already started, and nothing else moves. See Groups registered after the queue exists.

Q Start is refused: the track has no evaluation form.

With Track required on, every track needs its own form. Open Presentation Setup → Evaluation Configuration and Assign one to that track. The group's leader must also have a track from the list.

Q Start Room is disabled.

The day's planned start has not arrived, the date is overdue (edit it), the room is already started or closed, or Panelists per Room is not set.

Q End Room is refused.

A group is presenting or paused in that room. The Lead completes or defers it first.

Q I forgot to end the day.

It ends automatically at 11:00 PM, and unfinished groups carry over to the next day.

Q Can I change the presentation mode?

Only until the category's first day has started.

Q Can I delete a date?

Yes, unless a presentation was completed on it. Its groups move to other open rooms.

Q Can I edit a published evaluation form?

Yes — open it and press Edit Form. Criteria with recorded scores cannot be deleted, and changing weights does not re-score past evaluations.

Q I cannot see another college's categories or panelists.

By design: an Administrator only sees their own college.

Q **End Category is disabled.**

Some group still has to present, or a re-defense is pending.

Q **How do I get grades into a spreadsheet?**

Reports → Generated Grades → **Export to Excel** (or PDF), then tick the columns to include. Name, Section and Track are always included. The export follows the filters you set.

Technical problems

Q **A page looks broken or out of date.**

Reload it. If that does not help, clear the browser cache or try another up-to-date browser.

Q **"Page Expired" (419) when I submit a form.**

The page was open too long. Reload and submit again.

Q **The site says it is under maintenance or restoring.**

The Super Administrator is working on the system. Try again later.

Q **Changes don't appear on other screens.**

Most pages refresh every few seconds. Wait a moment or reload.

Q **An old tablet does not work.**

Open `/room-session/device-check` on it and update the browser, or use another device.

Q **How do I save this guide as a PDF?**

Press **Download PDF** at the top, choose "Save as PDF" as the printer and keep "Background graphics" on.

Getting more help

Students
Contact your college's Administrator or your capstone coordinator. Have your group reference ready.

Panelists
Contact the Administrator who registered you. On the day, ask the Administrator running Event Control.

Administrators

Contact the Super Administrator for accounts, colleges, school years, backups or system problems.

When reporting a problem, say what page you were on, what you clicked, the exact message shown, and the time. A screenshot helps.